Atiyah-Macdonald Exercises

Notation

Just a note on notation, $f = \sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k x^k \in A[x]$ can be identified with $[a_0, ..., a_k]$ for the sake of notational simplicity.

1 Rings and Ideals

Exercise 1.1. Let x be a nilpotent element of a ring A. Show that $1 + x$ is a unit of A. Deduce that the sum of a nilpotent element and a unit is a unit.

Proof: Idea: Think about Jordan blocks of matrices. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ be the smallest integer such that $x^n = 0$. Let

$$w = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} (-1)^k x^k.$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned} w(1+x) &= \left(1 + \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} (-1)^k x^k\right) + \sum_{k=1}^{n} (-1)^{k-1} x^k \\ &= 1 + \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} x^k \left((-1)^k + (-1)^{k-1}\right) = 1 \end{aligned}$$

Suppose $a \in R$ is a unit. Then let

$$(a+x)^{-1} = \frac{1}{a} \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} (-1)^k \left(\frac{x}{a}\right)^k$$

□

Exercise 1.2. Let A be a ring and let $A[x]$ be the ring of polynomials in an indeterminate x, with coefficients in A. Let $f = a_0 + a_1 x + ... + a_n x^n \in A[x]$. Prove that

i) f is a unit in $A[x] \Leftrightarrow a_0$ is a unit in A and $a_1, ..., a_n$ are nilpotent. [If $b_0 + b_1 x + ... + b_m x^m$ is the inverse of f, prove by induction on r that $a_n^{r+1} b_{m-r} = 0$. Hence show that a_n is nilpotent, and then use Ex. 1.]

ii) f is nilpotent $\Leftrightarrow a_0, a_1, ..., a_n$ are nilpotent.

iii) f is a zero-divisor $\Leftrightarrow$ there exists $a \neq 0$ in A such that $af = 0$. [Choose a polynomial $g = b_0 + b_1 x + ... + b_m x^m$ of least degree m such that $fg = 0$. Then $a_n b_m = 0$, hence $a_n g = 0$ (because $a_n g$ annihilates f and has degree $< m$). Now show by induction that $a_{n-r} g = 0$ $(0 \leq r \leq n)$.]

iv) f is said to be **primitive** if $(a_0, a_1, ..., a_n) = (1)$. Prove that if $f, g \in A[x]$, then fg is primitive $\Leftrightarrow f$ and g are primitive.

Proof:

i) $\Rightarrow$: This direction requires two steps of induction. We will first induct on the degree and then internally we will do a secondary induction to show that the last coefficient is nilpotent. For all degree 0 units in $A[x]$ the statement is trivially true. Suppose for the sake of induction, that for all degree $k \leq n$ polynomials that are units that the constant term is a unit in A and the higher coefficients are nilpotent. Suppose f is a degree $n+1$ polynomial

$$f = \sum_{k=0}^{n+1} a_k x^k,$$

such that f is a unit in $A[x]$. Let

$$g = \sum_{l=0}^{m} b_l x^l$$

be the inverse of f. Then we have that

$$\begin{aligned} fg &= \sum_{k=0}^{n+1} \left(\sum_{l=0}^{m} a_k b_l \right) x^{k+l} \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{n+m+1} \left(\sum_{l=\max(0,k-m)}^{\min(n+1,k)} a_l b_{k-l} \right) x^k \\ &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

Thus we know that $a_{n+1} b_{n+1} = 0$. Assume for the sake of induction that

$$a_{n+1}^{s+1} b_{m-s} = 0$$

for all $s \leq r$. Then examine the coefficient of x^{n+m-r} in fg we have the following sum

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \sum_{l=\max(0,n-r)}^{\min(n+1,n+m-r)} a_l b_{(n+m-r)-l} \\ &= \sum_{l=\max(0,n-r)}^{n+1} a_l b_{(n+m)-r-l} \\ &= a_{n+1}^{r+1} \sum_{l=\max(0,n-r)}^{n} a_l b_{(n+m)-r-l} \\ &= a_{n+1}^{r+2} b_{(n+m)-n-1-r} = a_{n+1}^{r+2} b_{m-(r-1)}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus by induction we know that $a_{n+1}^m b_0 = 0$. Since b_0 must be a unit, $a_{n+1}^m = 0$. Since f is a unit, $f - a_{n+1} x^{n+1}$ is a unit and by the inductive hypothesis, a_1, ..., a_n are nilpotent.

$\Leftarrow$: Immediate using exercise 1.

ii) $\Rightarrow$: Suppose $f = \sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k x^k$ is nilpotent. Then $f+1$ is unit. But then we know that $a_1, ..., a_n$ are nilpotent. To get that a_0 is nilpotent, just look at the constant term in $f^k = 0$ which is a_0^k, it must be zero and thus $a_0^k = 0$.

$\Longleftarrow$: We will prove a general statement. Suppose $a, b \in R$ are nilpotent. Then $a+b$ is nilpotent. Suppose $a^n = 0$ and $b^m = 0$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}(a+b)^{n+m} &= \sum_{k=0}^{n+m} \binom{n+m}{k} a^k b^{n+m-k} \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{n} \binom{n+m}{k} a^k b^{m+(n-k)} + \sum_{k=n+1}^{n+m} \binom{n+m}{k} a^k b^{m+n-k} \\ &= 0\end{aligned}$$

Thus $a+b$ is nilpotent. In fact, the set of nilpotent elements form a ideal. This means that f is nilpotent since $a_k x^k$ is nilpotent for all $k \in \{0, ..., n\}$.

iii) Only one direction is interesting. We first prove the claim that if $f = [a_0, ..., a_m] \in A[x]$ is a zero-divisor, then its corresponding g (in the context of this problem) has the property that $a_k g = 0$ for all k. We will do this by induction on the degree of f. The claim is trivially true for degree 0 zero-divisor. Suppose the claim is true for all zero-divisor divisors of degree less than or equal to n. Let $f = [a_0, ..., a_{n+1}]$ be a degree $n+1$ zero-divisor and let $g = [b_0, ..., b_m]$ be its corresponding zero-divisor (of minimal degree). The x^{m+n+1} coefficient of fg is $a_{n+1} b_m = 0$. Then $a_{n+1} g$ has smaller degree than g and $a_{n+1} g f = 0 \Rightarrow a_{n+1} g = 0$ by minimality of g. Now consider $f' = f - a_{n+1} x^n$ is a polynomial of degree at most n. Furthermore, $f' g = fg - a_{n+1} g = 0$. By the inductive hypothesis, each coefficent of the polynomial must multiply with g to equal 0, the coefficients of f' are $a_0, ..., a_n$. Thus $b_m a_k = 0$. Then $b_m f = 0$.

iv) Going forward doesn't seem too bad, basically you show that the ideal generated by the coefficients of fg is contained in the ideal $(a_1, ..., a_n)$ (and equivalently $(b_1, ..., b_n)$). You basically just use the coefficients of fg are polynomial in the coefficents of f and g themselves with the coefficients lying in A, hence ideals are closed under addition and multiplication by elements in A. Suppose f and g are primitive. Assume the contrary, that fg is not primitive, let $c(fg)$ denote the ideal generated by the coefficients of fg. Thus there exists a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m} \supset c(fg)$. $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is a field. Consider $f, g \in A/\mathfrak{m}[x]$ (image under quotient map) are not zero divisors since they are nonzero and $(A/\mathfrak{m})[m]$ is a integral domain. The image of fg under the quotient map is 0 though which is a contradiction. Hence fg must be primitive.

□

Exercise 1.3. Generalize the results of Exercise 2 to a polynomial ring $A[x_1, ..., x_r]$ in several indeterminates.

Proof: Note the following, there is a isomorphism between $A[x_1, ..., x_r] \cong (A[x_1, ..., x_{r-1}])[y]$. We will basically exploit this isomorphism to run a inductive argument on the number of indeterminates. Suppose the statements are true for polynomials in $A[x_1, ..., x_k]$. Let $f \in A[x_1, ..., x_{k+1}]$, f can be viewed as a element of $A[x_1, ..., x_k][x_k]$.

$$f = \sum_{i=0}^{n} P_i x_r^i$$
$$P_i \in A[x_1, ..., x_k].$$

Apply the previous exercise to get statements about the coefficients P_k and then use inductive hypothesis. □

Exercise 1.4. In the ring $A[x]$, the Jacobson radical is equal to the nilradical.

Proof: We want to show that $\mathfrak{N} \subseteq \mathfrak{R}$ (nilradical is contained in Jacobson radical) and $\mathfrak{R} \subseteq \mathfrak{N}$. All maximal ideals are prime, hence the intersection of all prime ideals $\mathfrak{N}$ must lie in the intersection of all maximal ideals $\mathfrak{R}$. So the nontrivial direction is showing that

$$\mathfrak{R} \subseteq \mathfrak{N}.$$

So now we need to show that if $f \in \mathfrak{R}$, ie in the intersection of all maximal ideals of $A[x]$, it is also in $f \in \mathfrak{N}$, or in the intersection of all prime ideals of $A[x]$. By Prop 1.9 (Atiyah-Macdonald), we know that

$$f \in \mathfrak{R} \Leftrightarrow 1 - fg \text{ unit}$$

for any choice of g. Thus we know that $1 - fx$ is unit. Hence all the coefficients of f must be nilpotent. Hence f must be nilpotent, hence $f \in \mathfrak{N}$. □

Exercise 1.5. Let A be a ring and let $A[[x]]$ be the ring of formal power series $f = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$ with coefficients in A. Show that

i) f is a unit in $A[[x]] \Leftrightarrow a_0$ is a unit in A.
ii) If f is nilpotent, then a_n is nilpotent for all $n \geq 0$. Is the converse true? (See Chapter 7, Exercise 2.)
iii) f belongs to the Jacobson radical of $A[[x]] \Leftrightarrow a_0$ belongs to the Jacobson radical of A.
iv) The contraction of a maximal ideal m of $A[[x]]$ is a maximal ideal of A, and m is generated by m^e and x.
v) Every prime ideal of A is the contraction of a prime ideal of $A[[x]]$.

Proof: **(a)**: Refer to homework 2 where a more general arguement is given for $A[[x_1, ..., x_n]]$.

(b): Suppose $f = [a_i]_{i=0}^{\infty}$ is nilpotent. Consider $g_k = [a_0, ..., a_k]$, we will show that g_k is nilpotent for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$ hence $a_0, ..., a_k$ are nilpotent. Let

$$0 = f^n = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} b_k x^k$$

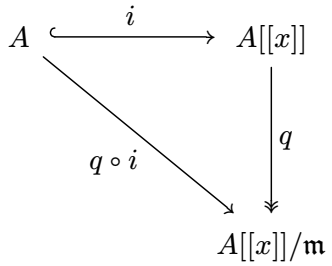
not that b_k for $k \in \{0, ..., nm\}$ are the coefficients of g_m^n. Thus since $b_k = 0 \Leftrightarrow g_m^n = 0 \Rightarrow g_m$ nilpotent. I am not able to say definitively whether or not a_n being nilpotent implies that f is nilpotent. But we know all finite sums of f are nilpotent. But I am not able to get anything stronger.

(c): Suppose $f = \left[\{a_n\}_{n=0}^{\infty}\right] \in \mathfrak{R}$ of $A[[x]]$. Thus for all $b \in A$, we know that $1 - fb$ is unit. Hence $1 - a_0 b$ is unit for any choice of $b \in A$. Hence by Prop. 1.6 (Atiyah-Macdonald) we know that $a_0 \in \mathfrak{R}$ of A. Suppose $a_0 \in \mathfrak{R}$ of A, for all $g \in A[[x]]$

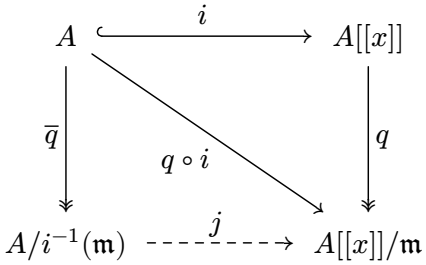
$$1 - fg \text{ unit} \Leftrightarrow 1 - g_0 a_0 \text{ unit}$$

and $1 - g_0 a_0$ is unit because $a_0 \in \mathfrak{R}$ of A. Hence by 1.9 again, $f \in \mathfrak{R}$ of $A[[x]]$.

(d): Note the following commutative diagram.



Note that $\ker(q \circ i) = i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})$ hence $q \circ i$ factors through $\bar{i} : A \to A/i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})$ and we get the following diagram.



Note that j is a injection, bc $j(k + i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})) = i(j) + \mathfrak{m} = \mathfrak{m} \Leftrightarrow i(j) \in \mathfrak{m} \Rightarrow j \in i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})$. Thus $i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})$ must be at least a prime ideal of A because $A/i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})$ injects into a field and hence must at least be a domain. We know that $0 \in \mathfrak{R}$ trivially. Then for any $[a_n]_{n=1}^{\infty} \in A[[x]]$, power series with constant term 0, $[a_n]_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathfrak{R}$. Consider $a + i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m}) \neq 0$.

$$a + i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m}) = a + \mathfrak{m}$$

through j. $\exists f = [f_k]_{k=0}^{\infty} \in A[[x]]$ such that

$$af = 1 \in A[[x]]/\mathfrak{m}.$$

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} f_k x^k \in \mathfrak{R} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}.$$

Thus

$$af_0 = a\left(f - \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} f_k x^k\right) = 1 + a\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} f_k x^k = 1 \in A[[x]]/\mathfrak{m} \Rightarrow af_0 = 1 \in A/i^{-1}(\mathfrak{m})$$

$\forall g = [g_k]_{k=0}^{\infty} \in \mathfrak{m}$ we want to show that $g_k \in \mathfrak{m}^c$ for all k.

i) Case 1 $k = 0$: $[g_n]_{n=1}^{\infty} \in \mathfrak{R} \subset \mathfrak{m} \Rightarrow g - [g_n]_{n=1}^{\infty} = g_0 \in \mathfrak{m} \Rightarrow g_0 \in \mathfrak{m}^c$.

ii) Case 2 $k > 0$: Assume the contrary that $g_k \notin \mathfrak{m}^c$. By a similar trick as above and using the fact $g_0 \in \mathfrak{m}^c$ we can isolate the $g_k x^k$ term, $g_k x^k \in \mathfrak{m}$. Thus $(\mathfrak{m}^c, g_0)(x) \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$. $(\mathfrak{m}^c, g_0) = A$, my maximality. Thus $1 \in (\mathfrak{m}^c, g_0) \subset \mathfrak{m} \Rightarrow \mathfrak{m} = A[[x]]$, contradicting maximality of $\mathfrak{m}$.

□

Exercise 1.6. A ring A is such that every ideal not contained in the nilradical contains a nonzero idempotent (that is, an element e such that $e^2 = e \neq 0$). Prove that the nilradical and Jacobson radical of A are equal.

Proof: It suffices to show that

$$\mathfrak{R} \subseteq \mathfrak{N}.$$

Assume the contrary, that $\mathfrak{R} \nsubseteq \mathfrak{N}$. Thus $\exists e \in \mathfrak{R}$ such that $e \neq 0$ and $e^2 = e$. By Prop 1.9, $1 - e^2 = 1 - e$ is a unit. Let $f = (1-e)^{-1}$. Note the following computation,

$$e = e(1-e)f = (e - e^2)f = (e - e)f = 0.$$

This is a contradiction. Hence $\mathfrak{R} \subseteq \mathfrak{N}$ and $\mathfrak{R} = \mathfrak{N}$. □

Exercise 1.7. Let A be a ring in which every element x satisfies $x^n = x$ for some $n > 1$ (depending on x). Show that every prime ideal in A is maximal.

Proof: The problem is equivalent to showing that $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is a field for any prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$. Fix $\mathfrak{p} \in \operatorname{Spec}(A)$. We want to show that $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is a field.

$$x^n - x = 0 = x(x^{n-1} - 1).$$

Thus in $A/\mathfrak{p}$ which is a domain, either $x = 0$ or $x^{n-1} - 1 = 0$. Thus if $x \neq 0$, then $x^{n-1} = 1$. Thus $x^{n-2}x = 1$ and x is unit. Thus every nonzero element in $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is unit and $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is a field and $\mathfrak{p}$ is maximal. □

Exercise 1.8. Let A be a ring $\neq 0$. Show that the set of prime ideals of A has minimal elements with respect to inclusion.

Proof: Let $\operatorname{Spec}(A)$ denote the set of prime ideals of A, and use $\supseteq$ as the comparison operator on the set. Let C be a arbitrary chain in $\operatorname{Spec}(A)$. Consider

$$I = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{p} \in C} \mathfrak{p},$$

which is an ideal of A. We want to show I is prime. For $\mathfrak{p} \in C$, let $f_{\mathfrak{p}} : A \to A/\mathfrak{p}$ be the standard quotient. Note that f factors through $\tilde{f}_{\mathfrak{p}} : A/I \to A/\mathfrak{p}$. Let $x, y \in A/I$ be elements where $xy = 0$ then $0 = \tilde{f}_{\mathfrak{p}}(xy) = \tilde{f}_{\mathfrak{p}}(x)\tilde{f}_{\mathfrak{p}}(y) \Rightarrow \tilde{f}_{\mathfrak{p}}(x) = 0$ or $\tilde{f}_{\mathfrak{p}}(y) = 0$. Meaning $\forall \mathfrak{p} \in C$, $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ or $y \in \mathfrak{p}$. Note the following, if $\mathfrak{p} \not\ni x \Rightarrow \mathfrak{q} \not\ni x \wedge I \not\ni x$ for all $\mathfrak{q} \in C$ where $\mathfrak{p} \supseteq \mathfrak{q}$.

i) $\forall \mathfrak{p} \in C$ suppose there $\exists z \in \{x, y\}$. Such that $z \in \mathfrak{p}$, thus $z \in I$ and either $x = 0$ or $y = 0$ in A/I.

ii) $\exists \mathfrak{p} \in C$ where $x \in \mathfrak{p} \in C$ but $x \notin \mathfrak{q} \in C$ $(y \in \mathfrak{q})$. If $\mathfrak{p} \supset \mathfrak{q} \Rightarrow y \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $y \in I \Rightarrow y = 0 \in A/I$. If $\mathfrak{q} \supseteq \mathfrak{p}$, this is not possible.

Thus A/I is a domain. By Zorn's Lemma, exists minimal elements in $\operatorname{Spec}(A)$. □

Exercise 1.9. Let a be an ideal $\neq (1)$ in a ring A. Show that $a = r(a) \Leftrightarrow a$ is an intersection of prime ideals.

Proof: $\Rightarrow$: Suppose $a = r(a)$. Consider $q : A \to A/a$, note that $a = r(a) = q^{-1}(\mathfrak{N}(A/a))$. Thus

$$a = q^{-1}\left(\bigcap_{p \in \operatorname{Spec}(A/a)} \mathfrak{p}\right) = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{p} \in \operatorname{Spec}(A/a)} q^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}) = \bigcap_{\substack{\mathfrak{p} \in \operatorname{Spec}(A) \\ a \subseteq \mathfrak{p}}} \mathfrak{p}$$

$\Longleftarrow$: Suppose

$$a = \bigcap_{\substack{\mathfrak{p} \in \operatorname{Spec}(A) \\ a \subseteq \mathfrak{p}}} \mathfrak{p}.$$

Let $q : A \to A/a$. Thus

$$\begin{aligned} a &= \bigcap_{\mathfrak{p} \in \operatorname{Spec}(A/a)} q^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}) \\ &= q^{-1}\left(\bigcap_{\mathfrak{p} \in \operatorname{Spec}(A/a)} \mathfrak{p}\right) \\ &= q^{-1}(\mathfrak{N}(A/a)) \\ &= r(a) \end{aligned}$$

□

Exercise 1.10. Let A be a ring, $\mathfrak{N}$ its nilradical. Show that the following are equivalent:

i) A has exactly one prime ideal;

ii) every element of A is either a unit or nilpotent;

iii) $A/\mathfrak{N}$ is a field.

Proof: Lowk trivial. □

Exercise 1.11. A ring A is Boolean if $x^2 = x$ for all $x \in A$. In a Boolean ring A, show that

i) $2x = 0$ for all $x \in A$;
ii) every prime ideal p is maximal, and A/p is a field with two elements;
iii) every finitely generated ideal in A is principal.

Proof: Suppose A is a Boolean ring.

i) $$x + 1 = (x + 1)^2 = x^2 + 2x + 1 = x + 2x + 1 \Rightarrow 2x = 0.$$

ii) First section of the question is exercise 2.7.

iii) We want to show $(x, y) = (x + y + xy)$. One direction is trivial. The other, notice $x(x + y + xy) = x$ and $y(x + y + xy) = y$. To get the generality, proceed by induction on number of generators.

□

Definition 1.1 (Local Ring). A is a local ring if and only if there is only 1 maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is called the residue field of A.

Exercise 1.12. A local ring contains no idempotent $\neq 0, 1$.

Proof: Let A be a local ring. Let $x \notin \{0, 1\}$ be a idempotent of A. □

1.1 Construction of an algebraic closure of a field (E. Artin)

Exercise 1.13. Let K be a field and let Σ be the set of all irreducible monic polynomials f in one indeterminate with coefficients in K. Let A be the polynomial ring over K generated by indeterminates x_f, one for each $f \in \Sigma$. Let a be the ideal of A generated by the polynomials $f(x_f)$ for all $f \in \Sigma$. Show that $a \neq (1)$.

Let m be a maximal ideal of A containing a, and let $K_1 = A/m$. Then K_1 is an extension field of K in which each $f \in \Sigma$ has a root. Repeat the construction with K_1 in place of K, obtaining a field K_2, and so on. Let $L = \cup_{n=1}^{\infty} K_n$. Then L is a field in which each $f \in \Sigma$ splits completely into linear factors. Let $\overline{K}$ be the set of all elements of L which are algebraic over K. Then $\overline{K}$ is an algebraic closure of K.

Exercise 1.14. In a ring A, let Σ be the set of all ideals in which every element is a zero-divisor. Show that the set Σ has maximal elements and that every maximal element of Σ is a prime ideal. Hence the set of zero-divisors in A is a union of prime ideals.

1.2 The prime spectrum of a ring

Exercise 1.15. Let A be a ring and let X be the set of all prime ideals of A. For each subset E of A, let $V(E)$ denote the set of all prime ideals of A which contain E. Prove that

i) if a is the ideal generated by E, then $V(E) = V(a) = V(r(a))$.
ii) $V(0) = X$, $V(1) = \emptyset$.
iii) if $(E_i)_{i\in I}$ is any family of subsets of A, then

$$V\left(\bigcup_{i\in I} E_i\right) = \bigcap_{i\in I} V(E_i).$$

iv) $V(a \cap b) = V(ab) = V(a) \cup V(b)$ for any ideals a, b of A.

These results show that the sets $V(E)$ satisfy the axioms for closed sets in a topological space. The resulting topology is called the **Zariski topology**. The topological space X is called the **prime spectrum** of A, and is written $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$.

Proof:
i) If $E \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$, then all finite A-linear combinations of E is contained in $\mathfrak{p}$ (by definition of ideal), thus $E \subseteq a \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. Thus $V(E) \subseteq V(a)$. Suppose $a \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \Rightarrow E \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \Rightarrow V(a) \subseteq V(E)$. Look at

$$r(a) = \bigcap_{\substack{\mathfrak{p}\in \mathrm{Spec}(A)\\ a\subseteq\mathfrak{p}}} \mathfrak{p}.$$

Thus if $r(a) \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \Rightarrow a \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \Rightarrow V(a) \subseteq V(r(a))$. Furthermore, if $a \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \Rightarrow r(a) \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \Rightarrow V(r(a)) \subseteq V(a)$. Thus $V(a) = V(r(a))$.
ii) $V(0) := \{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathrm{Spec}(A) : (0) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\} = \{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathrm{Spec}(A) : 0 \in \mathfrak{p}\} = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$. On the other hand $V(X) := \{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathrm{Spec}(A) : A \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\} = \emptyset$ because each prime ideal is contained in A and A itself is not prime.
iii) Let $(E_i)_{i\in I}$ be a family of subsets of A.

$$\begin{aligned} V\left(\bigcup_{i\in I} E_i\right) &= \left\{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathrm{Spec}(A) : \bigcup_{i\in I} E_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\right\} \\ &= \{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathrm{Spec}(A) : \text{for all } i \in I, E_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\} \\ &= \bigcap_{i\in I} \{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathrm{Spec}(A) : E_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\} \\ &= \bigcap_{i\in I} V(E_i). \end{aligned}$$

□

Exercise 1.16. Draw pictures of $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{Z})$, $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{R})$, $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x])$, $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{R}[x])$, $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{Z}[x])$.

Proof:

□

Exercise 1.17. For each $f \in A$, let X_f denote the complement of $V(f)$ in $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$. The sets X_f are open. Show that they form a basis of open sets for the Zariski topology, and that

i) $X_f \cap X_g = X_{fg}$;
ii) $X_f = \emptyset \Leftrightarrow f$ is nilpotent;
iii) $X_f = X \Leftrightarrow f$ is a unit;
iv) $X_f = X_g \Leftrightarrow r((f)) = r((g))$;
v) X is quasi-compact (that is, every open covering of X has a finite subcovering).
vi) More generally, each X_f is quasi-compact.
vii) An open subset of X is quasi-compact if and only if it is a finite union of sets X_f.

The sets X_f are called **basic open sets** of $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$.

[To prove (v), remark that it is enough to consider a covering of X by basic open sets X_{f_i} $(i \in I)$. Show that the f_i generate the unit ideal and hence that there is an equation of the form

$$1 = \sum_{i \in J} g_i f_i \quad (g_i \in A)$$

where J is some finite subset of I. Then the X_{f_i} $(i \in J)$ cover X.]

Exercise 1.18. For psychological reasons it is sometimes convenient to denote a prime ideal of A by a letter such as x or y when thinking of it as a point of $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$. When thinking of x as a prime ideal of A, we denote it by p_x (logically, of course, it is the same thing). Show that
i) the set $\{x\}$ is closed (we say that x is a "closed point") in $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \Leftrightarrow p_x$ is maximal;
ii) $\overline{\{x\}} = V(p_x)$;
iii) $y \in \overline{\{x\}} \Leftrightarrow p_x \subseteq p_y$;
iv) X is a T_0-space (this means that if x, y are distinct points of X, then either there is a neighborhood of x which does not contain y, or else there is a neighborhood of y which does not contain x).

Exercise 1.19. A topological space X is said to be **irreducible** if $X \neq \emptyset$ and if every pair of non-empty open sets in X intersect, or equivalently if every non-empty open set is dense in X. Show that $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is irreducible if and only if the nilradical of A is a prime ideal.

Exercise 1.20. Let X be a topological space.
i) If Y is an irreducible (Exercise 19) subspace of X, then the closure $\overline{Y}$ of Y in X is irreducible.
ii) Every irreducible subspace of X is contained in a maximal irreducible subspace.
iii) The maximal irreducible subspaces of X are closed and cover X. They are called the **irreducible components** of X. What are the irreducible components of a Hausdorff space?
iv) If A is a ring and $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, then the irreducible components of X are the closed sets $V(p)$, where p is a minimal prime ideal of A (Exercise 8).

Exercise 1.21. Let $\varphi : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism. Let $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ and $Y = \mathrm{Spec}(B)$. If $q \in Y$, then $\varphi^{-1}(q)$ is a prime ideal of A, i.e., a point of X. Hence φ induces a mapping $\varphi^* : Y \to X$. Show that

i) if $f \in A$ then $(\varphi^*)^{-1}(X_f) = Y_{\varphi(f)}$, and hence that φ^* is continuous.
ii) if a is an ideal of A, then $(\varphi^*)^{-1}(V(a)) = V(a^e)$.
iii) if b is an ideal of B, then $\overline{\varphi^*(V(b))} = V(b^c)$.
iv) if φ is surjective, then φ^* is a homeomorphism of Y onto the closed subset $V(\ker(\varphi))$ of X. (In particular, $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ and $\mathrm{Spec}(A/\mathfrak{N})$ (where $\mathfrak{N}$ is the nilradical of A) are naturally homeomorphic.)
v) if φ is injective, then $\varphi^*(Y)$ is dense in X. More precisely, $\varphi^*(Y)$ is dense in $X \Leftrightarrow \ker(\varphi) \subseteq \mathfrak{N}$.
vi) let $\psi : B \to C$ be another ring homomorphism. Then $(\psi \circ \varphi)^* = \varphi^* \circ \psi^*$.
vii) let A be an integral domain with just one non-zero prime ideal p, and let K be the field of fractions of A. Let $B = (A/p) \times K$. Define $\varphi : A \to B$ by $\varphi(x) = (\overline{x}, x)$, where $\overline{x}$ is the image of x in A/p. Show that φ^* is bijective but not a homeomorphism.

Exercise 1.22. Let $A = \prod_{i=1}^n A_i$ be the direct product of rings A_i. Show that $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is the disjoint union of open (and closed) subspaces X_i, where X_i is canonically homeomorphic with $\mathrm{Spec}(A_i)$.

Conversely, let A be any ring. Show that the following statements are equivalent:
i) $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is disconnected.
ii) $A \cong A_1 \times A_2$ where neither of the rings A_1, A_2 is the zero ring.
iii) A contains an idempotent $\neq 0, 1$.

In particular, the spectrum of a local ring is always connected (Exercise 12).

Exercise 1.23. Let A be a Boolean ring (Exercise 11), and let $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$.
i) For each $f \in A$, the set X_f (Exercise 17) is both open and closed in X.
ii) Let $f_1, ..., f_n \in A$. Show that $X_{f_1} \cup ... \cup X_{f_n} = X_f$ for some $f \in A$.
iii) The sets X_f are the only subsets of X which are both open and closed. [Let $Y \subseteq X$ be both open and closed. Since Y is open, it is a union of basic open sets X_f. Since Y is closed and X is quasi-compact (Exercise 17), Y is quasi-compact. Hence Y is a finite union of basic open sets; now use (ii) above.]
iv) X is a compact Hausdorff space.

Exercise 1.24. Let L be a lattice, in which the sup and inf of two elements a, b are denoted by $a \bigvee b$ and $a \bigwedge b$ respectively. L is a **Boolean lattice** (or **Boolean algebra**) if
i) L has a least element and a greatest element (denoted by $0, 1$ respectively).
ii) Each of $\bigvee, \bigwedge$ is distributive over the other.
iii) Each $a \in L$ has a unique "complement" $a' \in L$ such that $a \bigvee a' = 1$ and $a \bigwedge a' = 0$.

(For example, the set of all subsets of a set, ordered by inclusion, is a Boolean lattice.)

Let L be a Boolean lattice. Define addition and multiplication in L by the rules

$$a + b = \left(a \bigwedge b'\right) \bigvee \left(a' \bigwedge b\right), \quad ab = a \bigwedge b.$$

Verify that in this way L becomes a Boolean ring, $A(L)$.

Conversely, starting from a Boolean ring A, define an ordering on A as follows: $a \leq b$ means that $a = ab$. Show that, with respect to this ordering, A is a Boolean lattice. [The sup and inf are given by $a \bigvee b = a + b + ab$ and $a \bigwedge b = ab$, and the complement by $a' = 1 - a$.] In this way we obtain a one-to-one correspondence between (isomorphism classes of) Boolean rings and (isomorphism classes of) Boolean lattices.

Exercise 1.25. From the last two exercises deduce Stone's theorem, that every Boolean lattice is isomorphic to the lattice of open-and-closed subsets of some compact Hausdorff topological space.

Exercise 1.26. Let A be a ring. The subspace of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ consisting of the maximal ideals of A, with the induced topology, is called the **maximal spectrum** of A and is denoted by $\mathrm{Max}(A)$. For arbitrary commutative rings it does not have the nice functorial properties of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ (see Exercise 21), because the inverse image of a maximal ideal under a ring homomorphism need not be maximal.

Let X be a compact Hausdorff space and let $C(X)$ denote the ring of all real-valued continuous functions on X (add and multiply functions by adding and multiplying their values). For each $x \in X$, let m_x be the set of all $f \in C(X)$ such that $f(x) = 0$. The ideal m_x is maximal, because it is the kernel of the (surjective) homomorphism $C(X) \to \mathbb{R}$ which takes f to $f(x)$. If $\tilde{X}$ denotes $\mathrm{Max}(C(X))$, we have therefore defined a mapping $\mu : X \to \tilde{X}$, namely $x \mapsto m_x$.

We shall show that μ is a homeomorphism of X onto $\tilde{X}$.

i) Let m be any maximal ideal of $C(X)$, and let $V = V(m)$ be the set of common zeros of the functions in m: that is,

$$V = \{x \in X : f(x) = 0 \text{ for all } f \in m\}.$$

Suppose that V is empty. Then for each $x \in X$ there exists $f_x \in C(X)$ such that $f_x(x) \neq 0$. Since f_x is continuous, there is an open neighborhood U_x of x in X on which f_x does not vanish. By compactness a finite number of the neighborhoods, say $U_{x_1}, ..., U_{x_n}$, cover X. Let

$$f = f_{x_1}^2 + ... + f_{x_n}^2.$$

Then f does not vanish at any point of X, hence is a unit in $C(X)$. But this contradicts $f \in m$, hence V is not empty.

Let x be a point of V. Then $m \subseteq m_x$, hence $m = m_x$ because m is maximal. Hence μ is surjective.

ii) By Urysohn's lemma (this is the only non-trivial fact required in the argument) the continuous functions separate the points of X. Hence $x \neq y \Rightarrow m_x \neq m_y$, and therefore μ is injective.

iii) Let $f \in C(X)$; let

$$U_f = \{x \in X : f(x) \neq 0\}$$

and let

$$\tilde{U}_f = \{m \in \tilde{X} : f \nmid m\}.$$

Show that $\mu(U_f) = \tilde{U}_f$. The open sets U_f (resp. $\tilde{U}_f$) form a basis of the topology of X (resp. $\tilde{X}$) and therefore μ is a homeomorphism.

Thus X can be reconstructed from the ring of functions $C(X)$.

1.3 Affine algebraic varieties

Exercise 1.27. Let k be an algebraically closed field and let

$$f_\alpha(t_1, ..., t_n) = 0$$

be a set of polynomial equations in n variables with coefficients in k. The set X of all points $x = (x_1, ..., x_n) \in k^n$ which satisfy these equations is an **affine algebraic variety**.

Consider the set of all polynomials $g \in k[t_1, ..., t_n]$ with the property that $g(x) = 0$ for all $x \in X$. This set is an ideal $I(X)$ in the polynomial ring, and is called the **ideal of the variety** X. The quotient ring

$$P(X) = k[t_1, ..., t_n]/I(X)$$

is the ring of polynomial functions on X, because two polynomials g, h define the same polynomial function on X if and only if $g - h$ vanishes at every point of X, that is, if and only if $g - h \in I(X)$.

Let ξ_i be the image of t_i in $P(X)$. The ξ_i $(1 \leq i \leq n)$ are the **coordinate functions** on X: if $x \in X$, then $\xi_i(x)$ is the ith coordinate of x. $P(X)$ is generated as a k-algebra by the coordinate functions, and is called the **coordinate ring** (or **affine algebra**) of X.

As in Exercise 26, for each $x \in X$ let m_x be the ideal of all $f \in P(X)$ such that $f(x) = 0$; it is a maximal ideal of $P(X)$. Hence, if $\tilde{X} = \mathrm{Max}(P(X))$, we have defined a mapping $\mu : X \to \tilde{X}$, namely $x \mapsto m_x$.

It is easy to show that μ is injective: if $x \neq y$, we must have $x_i \neq y_i$ for some i $(1 \leq i \leq n)$, and hence $\xi_i - y_i$ is in m_x but not in m_y, so that $m_x \neq m_y$. What is less obvious (but still true) is that μ is surjective. This is one form of Hilbert's Nullstellensatz (see Chapter 7).

Exercise 1.28. Let $f_1, ..., f_m$ be elements of $k[t_1, ..., t_n]$. They determine a **polynomial mapping** $\varphi : k^n \to k^m$: if $x \in k^n$, the coordinates of $\varphi(x)$ are $f_1(x), ..., f_{m(x)}$. Let X, Y be affine algebraic varieties in k^n, k^m respectively. A mapping $\varphi : X \to Y$ is said to be **regular** if φ is the restriction to X of a polynomial mapping from k^n to k^m.

If η is a polynomial function on Y, then $\eta \circ \varphi$ is a polynomial function on X. Hence φ induces a k -algebra homomorphism $P(Y) \to P(X)$, namely $\eta \mapsto \eta \circ \varphi$. Show that in this way we obtain a one-to-one correspondence between the regular mappings $X \to Y$ and the k-algebra homomorphisms $P(Y) \to P(X)$.

2 Modules

Exercise 2.1. Show that $(\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}) = 0$ if m, n are coprime.

Exercise 2.2. Let A be a ring, a an ideal, M an A-module. Show that $(A/a) \otimes_A M$ is isomorphic to M/aM. [Tensor the exact sequence $0 \to a \to A \to A/a \to 0$ with M.]

Exercise 2.3. Let A be a local ring, M and N finitely generated A-modules. Prove that if $M \otimes N = 0$, then $M = 0$ or $N = 0$. [Let m be the maximal ideal, $k = A/m$ the residue field. Let $M_k = k \otimes_A M \cong M/mM$ by Exercise 2. By Nakayama's lemma, $M_k = 0 \Rightarrow M = 0$. But $M \otimes_A N = 0 \Rightarrow (M \otimes_A N)_k = 0 \Rightarrow M_k \otimes_k N_k = 0 \Rightarrow M_k = 0$ or $N_k = 0$, since M_k, N_k are vector spaces over a field.]

Exercise 2.4. Let M_i $(i \in I)$ be any family of A-modules, and let M be their direct sum. Prove that M is flat $\Leftrightarrow$ each M_i is flat.

Exercise 2.5. Let $A[x]$ be the ring of polynomials in one indeterminate over a ring A. Prove that $A[x]$ is a flat A-algebra. [Use Exercise 4.]

Exercise 2.6. For any A-module M, let $M[x]$ denote the set of all polynomials in x with coefficients in M, that is to say expressions of the form

$$m_0 + m_1 x + ... + m_r x^r \quad (m_i \in M).$$

Defining the product of an element of $A[x]$ and an element of $M[x]$ in the obvious way, show that $M[x]$ is an $A[x]$-module.

Show that $M[x] \cong A[x] \otimes_A M$.

Exercise 2.7. Let p be a prime ideal in A. Show that $p[x]$ is a prime ideal in $A[x]$. If m is a maximal ideal in A, is $m[x]$ a maximal ideal in $A[x]$?

Exercise 2.8.
i) If M and N are flat A-modules, then so is $M \otimes_A N$.
ii) If B is a flat A-algebra and N is a flat B-module, then N is flat as an A-module.

Exercise 2.9. Let $0 \to M' \to M \to M'' \to 0$ be an exact sequence of A-modules. If M' and M'' are finitely generated, then so is M.

Exercise 2.10. Let A be a ring, a an ideal contained in the Jacobson radical of A; let M be an A-module and N a finitely generated A-module, and let $u : M \to N$ be a homomorphism. If the induced homomorphism $M/aM \to N/aN$ is surjective, then u is surjective.

Exercise 2.11. Let A be a ring $\neq 0$. Show that $A^m \cong A^n \Rightarrow m = n$. [Let m be a maximal ideal of A and let $\varphi : A^m \to A^n$ be an isomorphism. Then $1 \otimes \varphi : (A/m) \otimes_A A^m \to (A/m) \otimes_A A^n$ is an isomorphism between vector spaces of dimensions m and n over the field $k = A/m$. Hence $m = n$.] (Cf. Chapter 3, Exercise 15.)

If $\varphi : A^m \to A^n$ is surjective, then $m \geq n$.

If $\varphi : A^m \to A^n$ is injective, is it always the case that $m \leq n$?

Exercise 2.12. Let M be a finitely generated A-module and $\varphi : M \to A^n$ a surjective homomorphism. Show that $\ker(\varphi)$ is finitely generated. [Let $e_1, ..., e_n$ be a basis of A^n and choose $u_i \in M$ such that $\varphi(u_i) = e_i$ $(1 \leq i \leq n)$. Show that M is the direct sum of $\ker(\varphi)$ and the submodule generated by $u_1, ..., u_n$.]

Exercise 2.13. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism, and let N be a B-module. Regarding N as an A-module by restriction of scalars, form the B-module $N_B = B \otimes_A N$. Show that the homomorphism $g : N \to N_B$ which maps y to $1 \otimes y$ is injective and that $g(N)$ is a direct summand of N_B. [Define $p : N_B \to N$ by $p(b \otimes y) = by$, and show that $N_B = \mathrm{im}(g) \oplus \ker(p)$.]

2.1 Direct limits

Exercise 2.14. A partially ordered set I is said to be a **directed set** if for each pair i, j in I there exists $k \in I$ such that $i \leq k$ and $j \leq k$.

Let A be a ring, let I be a directed set and let $(M_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of A-modules indexed by I. For each pair i, j in I such that $i \leq j$, let $\mu_{ij} : M_i \to M_j$ be an A-homomorphism, and suppose that the following axioms are satisfied: (1) μ_{ii} is the identity mapping of M_i, for all $i \in I$; (2) $\mu_{ik} = \mu_{jk} \circ \mu_{ij}$ whenever $i \leq j \leq k$.

Then the modules M_i and homomorphisms μ_{ij} are said to form a **direct system** $\boldsymbol{M} = \big(M_i, \mu_{ij}\big)$ over the directed set I.

We shall construct an A-module M called the **direct limit** of the direct system $\boldsymbol{M}$. Let C be the direct sum of the M_i, and identify each module M_i with its canonical image in C. Let D be the submodule of C generated by all elements of the form $x_i - \mu_{ij}(x_i)$ where $i \leq j$ and $x_i \in M_i$. Let $M = C/D$, let $\mu : C \to M$ be the projection and let μ_i be the restriction of μ to M_i.

The module M, or more correctly the pair consisting of M and the family of homomorphisms $\mu_i : M_i \to M$, is called the **direct limit** of the direct system $\boldsymbol{M}$, and is written $\lim_{\to} M_i$. From the construction it is clear that $\mu_i = \mu_j \circ \mu_{ij}$ whenever $i \leq j$.

Exercise 2.15. In the situation of Exercise 14, show that every element of M can be written in the form $\mu_i(x_i)$ for some $i \in I$ and some $x_i \in M_i$.

Show also that if $\mu_i(x_i) = 0$ then there exists $j \geq i$ such that $\mu_{ij}(x_i) = 0$ in M_j.

Exercise 2.16. Show that the direct limit is characterized (up to isomorphism) by the following property. Let N be an A-module and for each $i \in I$ let $\alpha_i : M_i \to N$ be an A-module homomorphism such that $\alpha_i = \alpha_j \circ \mu_{ij}$ whenever $i \leq j$. Then there exists a unique homomorphism $\alpha : M \to N$ such that $\alpha_i = \alpha \circ \mu_i$ for all $i \in I$.

Exercise 2.17. Let $(M_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of submodules of an A-module, such that for each pair of indices i, j in I there exists $k \in I$ such that $M_i + M_j \subseteq M_k$. Define $i \leq j$ to mean $M_i \subseteq M_j$ and let $\mu_{ij} : M_i \to M_j$ be the embedding of M_i in M_j. Show that

$$\lim_{\to} M_i = \sum_i M_i = \cup_i M_i.$$

In particular, any A-module is the direct limit of its finitely generated submodules.

Exercise 2.18. Let $\boldsymbol{M} = \big(M_i, \mu_{ij}\big)$, $\boldsymbol{N} = \big(N_i, \nu_{ij}\big)$ be direct systems of A-modules over the same directed set. Let M, N be the direct limits and $\mu_i : M_i \to M$, $\nu_i : N_i \to N$ the associated homomorphisms.

A **homomorphism** $\Phi : \boldsymbol{M} \to \boldsymbol{N}$ is by definition a family of A-module homomorphisms $\varphi_i : M_i \to N_i$ such that $\varphi_j \circ \mu_{ij} = \nu_{ij} \circ \varphi_i$ whenever $i \leq j$. Show that Φ defines a unique homomorphism $\varphi = \lim_{\to} \varphi_i : M \to N$ such that $\varphi \circ \mu_i = \nu_i \circ \varphi_i$ for all $i \in I$.

Exercise 2.19. A sequence of direct systems and homomorphisms

$$\boldsymbol{M} \to \boldsymbol{N} \to \boldsymbol{P}$$

is **exact** if the corresponding sequence of modules and module homomorphisms is exact for each $i \in I$. Show that the sequence $\lim_{\to} M_i \to \lim_{\to} N_i \to \lim_{\to} P_i$ of direct limits is then exact. [Use Exercise 15.]

2.2 Tensor products commute with direct limits

Exercise 2.20. Keeping the same notation as in Exercise 14, let N be any A-module. Then $\big(M_i \otimes N, \mu_{ij} \otimes 1\big)$ is a direct system; let $P = \lim_{\to}(M_i \otimes N)$ be its direct limit.

For each $i \in I$ we have a homomorphism $\mu_i \otimes 1 : M_i \otimes N \to M \otimes N$, hence by Exercise 16 a homomorphism $\psi : P \to M \otimes N$. Show that ψ is an isomorphism, so that

$$\varinjlim(M_i \otimes N) \cong \left(\varinjlim M_i\right) \otimes N.$$

[For each $i \in I$, let $g_i : M_i \times N \to M_i \otimes N$ be the canonical bilinear mapping. Passing to the limit we obtain a mapping $g : M \times N \to P$. Show that g is A-bilinear and hence define a homomorphism $\varphi : M \otimes N \to P$. Verify that $\varphi \circ \psi$ and $\psi \circ \varphi$ are identity mappings.]

Exercise 2.21. Let $(A_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of rings indexed by a directed set I, and for each pair $i \leq j$ in I let $\alpha_{ij} : A_i \to A_j$ be a ring homomorphism, satisfying conditions (1) and (2) of Exercise 14. Regarding each A_i as a $\mathbb{Z}$-module we can then form the direct limit $A = \varinjlim A_i$. Show that A inherits a ring structure from the A_i so that the mappings $A_i \to A$ are ring homomorphisms. The ring A is the **direct limit** of the system $\left(A_i, \alpha_{ij}\right)$.

If $A = 0$ prove that $A_i = 0$ for some $i \in I$. [Remember that all rings have identity elements!]

Exercise 2.22. Let $\left(A_i, \alpha_{ij}\right)$ be a direct system of rings and let $\mathfrak{n}_i$ be the nilradical of A_i. Show that $\varinjlim \mathfrak{n}_i$ is the nilradical of $\varinjlim A_i$.

If each A_i is an integral domain, then $\varinjlim A_i$ is an integral domain.

Exercise 2.23. Let $(B_\lambda)_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ be a family of A-algebras. For each finite subset J of Λ let B_J denote the tensor product (over A) of the B_λ for $\lambda \in J$. If J' is another finite subset of Λ, and $J \subseteq J'$, there is a canonical A-algebra homomorphism $B_J \to B_{J'}$. Let B denote the direct limit of the rings B_J as J runs through all finite subsets of Λ. The ring B has a natural A-algebra structure for which the homomorphisms $B_J \to B$ are A-algebra homomorphisms. The A-algebra B is the **tensor product** of the family $(B_\lambda)_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$.

2.3 Flatness and Tor

In these exercises it will be assumed that the reader is familiar with the definition and basic properties of the Tor functor.

Exercise 2.24. If M is an A-module, the following are equivalent:

i) M is flat;
ii) $\operatorname{Tor}_n^A(M, N) = 0$ for all $n > 0$ and all A-modules N;
iii) $\operatorname{Tor}_1^A(M, N) = 0$ for all A-modules N.

[To show that (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii), take a free resolution of N and tensor it with M. Since M is flat, the resulting sequence is exact and therefore its homology groups, which are the $\operatorname{Tor}_n^A(M, N)$, are zero for $n > 0$. To show that (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (i), let $0 \to N' \to N \to N'' \to 0$ be an exact sequence. Then, from the Tor exact sequence,

$$\operatorname{Tor}_1(M, N'') \to M \otimes N' \to M \otimes N \to M \otimes N'' \to 0$$

is exact. Since $\operatorname{Tor}_1(M, N'') = 0$ it follows that M is flat.]

Exercise 2.25. Let $0 \to N' \to N \to N'' \to 0$ be an exact sequence, with N'' flat. Then N' is flat $\Leftrightarrow N$ is flat. [Use Exercise 24 and the Tor exact sequence.]

Exercise 2.26. Let N be an A-module. Then N is flat $\Leftrightarrow \mathrm{Tor}_1(A/a, N) = 0$ for all finitely generated ideals a in A.

[Show first that N is flat if $\mathrm{Tor}_1(M, N) = 0$ for all finitely generated A-modules M, by using (2.19). If M is finitely generated, let $x_1, ..., x_n$ be a set of generators of M, and let M_i be the submodule generated by $x_1, ..., x_i$. By considering the successive quotients M_i/M_{i-1} and using Exercise 25, deduce that N is flat if $\mathrm{Tor}_1(M, N) = 0$ for all **cyclic** A-modules M, i.e., all M generated by a single element, and therefore of the form A/a for some ideal a. Finally use (2.19) again to reduce to the case where a is a finitely generated ideal.]

Exercise 2.27. A ring A is **absolutely flat** if every A-module is flat. Prove that the following are equivalent:

i) A is absolutely flat.
ii) Every principal ideal is idempotent.
iii) Every finitely generated ideal is a direct summand of A.

[i) $\Rightarrow$ ii). Let $x \in A$. Then $A/(x)$ is a flat A-module, hence in the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (x) \otimes A & \overset{\beta}{\to} & (x) \otimes (A/(x)) \\ \downarrow & & \overset{\alpha}{\downarrow} \\ A & \to & A/(x) \end{array}$$

the mapping α is injective. Hence $\mathrm{im}(\beta) = 0$, hence $(x) = (x^2)$. ii) $\Rightarrow$ iii). Let $x \in A$. Then $x = ax^2$ for some $a \in A$, hence $e = ax$ is idempotent and we have $(e) = (x)$. Now if e, f are idempotents, then $(e, f) = (e + f - ef)$. Hence every finitely generated ideal is principal, and generated by an idempotent e, hence is a direct summand because $A = (e) \oplus (1 - e)$. iii) $\Rightarrow$ i). Use the criterion of Exercise 26.]

Exercise 2.28. A Boolean ring is absolutely flat. The ring of Chapter 1, Exercise 7 is absolutely flat. Every homomorphic image of an absolutely flat ring is absolutely flat. If a local ring is absolutely flat, then it is a field.

If A is absolutely flat, every non-unit in A is a zero-divisor.

3 Rings and Modules of Fractions

Exercise 3.1. Let S be a multiplicatively closed subset of a ring A, and let M be a finitely generated A-module. Prove that $S^{-1}M = 0$ if and only if there exists $s \in S$ such that $sM = 0$.

Exercise 3.2. Let a be an ideal of a ring A, and let $S = 1 + a$. Show that $S^{-1}a$ is contained in the Jacobson radical of $S^{-1}A$.

Use this result and Nakayama's lemma to give a proof of (2.5) which does not depend on determinants. [If $M = aM$, then $S^{-1}M = (S^{-1}a)(S^{-1}M)$, hence by Nakayama we have $S^{-1}M = 0$. Now use Exercise 1.]

Exercise 3.3. Let A be a ring, let S and T be two multiplicatively closed subsets of A, and let U be the image of T in $S^{-1}A$. Show that the rings $(ST)^{-1}A$ and $U^{-1}(S^{-1}A)$ are isomorphic.

Exercise 3.4. Let $f : A \to B$ be a homomorphism of rings and let S be a multiplicatively closed subset of A. Let $T = f(S)$. Show that $S^{-1}B$ and $T^{-1}B$ are isomorphic as $S^{-1}A$-modules.

Exercise 3.5. Let A be a ring. Suppose that, for each prime ideal p, the local ring A_p has no nilpotent element $\neq 0$. Show that A has no nilpotent element $\neq 0$. If each A_p is an integral domain, is A necessarily an integral domain?

Exercise 3.6. Let A be a ring $\neq 0$ and let Σ be the set of all multiplicatively closed subsets S of A such that $0 \notin S$. Show that Σ has maximal elements, and that $S \in \Sigma$ is maximal if and only if $A - S$ is a minimal prime ideal of A.

Exercise 3.7. A multiplicatively closed subset S of a ring A is said to be **saturated** if

$$xy \in S \Leftrightarrow x \in S \text{ and } y \in S.$$

Prove that

i) S is saturated $\Leftrightarrow A - S$ is a union of prime ideals.

ii) If S is any multiplicatively closed subset of A, there is a unique smallest saturated multiplicatively closed subset $\overline{S}$ containing S, and that $\overline{S}$ is the complement in A of the union of the prime ideals which do not meet S. ($\overline{S}$ is called the **saturation** of S.)

If $S = 1 + a$, where a is an ideal of A, find $\overline{S}$.

Exercise 3.8. Let S, T be multiplicatively closed subsets of A, such that $S \subseteq T$. Let $\varphi : S^{-1}A \to T^{-1}A$ be the homomorphism which maps each $a/s \in S^{-1}A$ to a/s considered as an element of $T^{-1}A$. Show that the following statements are equivalent:

i) φ is bijective.

ii) For each $t \in T$, $t/1$ is a unit in $S^{-1}A$.

iii) For each $t \in T$ there exists $x \in A$ such that $xt \in S$.

iv) T is contained in the saturation of S (Exercise 7).

v) Every prime ideal which meets T also meets S.

Exercise 3.9. The set S_0 of all non-zero-divisors in A is a saturated multiplicatively closed subset of A. Hence the set D of zero-divisors in A is a union of prime ideals (see Chapter 1, Exercise 14). Show that every minimal prime ideal of A is contained in D. [Use Exercise 6.]

The ring $S_0^{-1}A$ is called the **total ring of fractions** of A. Prove that

i) S_0 is the largest multiplicatively closed subset of A for which the homomorphism $A \to S_0^{-1}A$ is injective.
ii) Every element in $S_0^{-1}A$ is either a zero-divisor or a unit.
iii) Every ring in which every non-unit is a zero-divisor is equal to its total ring of fractions (i.e., $A \to S_0^{-1}A$ is bijective).

Exercise 3.10. Let A be a ring.
i) If A is absolutely flat (Chapter 2, Exercise 27) and S is any multiplicatively closed subset of A, then $S^{-1}A$ is absolutely flat.
ii) A is absolutely flat $\Leftrightarrow A_m$ is a field for each maximal ideal m.

Exercise 3.11. Let A be a ring. Prove that the following are equivalent:
i) $A/\mathfrak{n}$ is absolutely flat ($\mathfrak{n}$ being the nilradical of A).
ii) Every prime ideal of A is maximal.
iii) $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a T_1-space (i.e., every subset consisting of a single point is closed).
iv) $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is Hausdorff.

If these conditions are satisfied, show that $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is compact and totally disconnected (i.e. the only connected subsets of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ are those consisting of a single point).

Exercise 3.12. Let A be an integral domain and M an A-module. An element $x \in M$ is a **torsion element** of M if $\mathrm{Ann}(x) \neq 0$, that is if x is killed by some non-zero element of A. Show that the torsion elements of M form a submodule of M. This submodule is called the **torsion submodule** of M and is denoted by $T(M)$. If $T(M) = 0$, the module M is said to be **torsion-free**. Show that
i) If M is any A-module, then $M/T(M)$ is torsion-free.
ii) If $f : M \to N$ is a module homomorphism, then $f(T(M)) \subseteq T(N)$.
iii) If $0 \to M' \to M \to M'' \to 0$ is an exact sequence, then the sequence $0 \to T(M') \to T(M) \to T(M'')$ is exact.
iv) If M is any A-module, then $T(M)$ is the kernel of the mapping $x \mapsto 1 \otimes x$ of M into $K \otimes_A M$, where K is the field of fractions of A.

[For iv), show that K may be regarded as the direct limit of its submodules $A\xi$ ($\xi \in K$); using Chapter 1, Exercise 15 and Exercise 20, show that if $1 \otimes x = 0$ in $K \otimes M$ then $\xi^{-1}x = 0$ in $A\xi \otimes M$ for some $\xi \neq 0$. Deduce that $\xi^{-1}x = 0$.]

Exercise 3.13. Let S be a multiplicatively closed subset of an integral domain A. In the notation of Exercise 12, show that $T(S^{-1}M) = S^{-1}(T(M))$. Deduce that the following are equivalent:
i) M is torsion-free.
ii) M_p is torsion-free for all prime ideals p.
iii) M_m is torsion-free for all maximal ideals m.

Exercise 3.14. Let M be an A-module and a an ideal of A. Suppose that $M_m = 0$ for all maximal ideals $m \supseteq a$. Prove that $M = aM$. [Pass to the A/a-module M/aM and use (3.8).]

Exercise 3.15. Let A be a ring, and let F be the A-module A^n. Show that every set of n generators of F is a basis of F. [Let $x_1, ..., x_n$ be a set of generators and $e_1, ..., e_n$ the canonical basis of F. Define $\varphi : F \to F$ by $\varphi(e_i) = x_i$. Then φ is surjective and we have to prove that it is an isomorphism. By (3.9) we may assume that A is a local ring. Since F is a flat A-module, the exact sequence $0 \to N \to F \to F \to 0$ given us an exact sequence $0 \to k \otimes N \to k \otimes F \xrightarrow{1\otimes\varphi} k \otimes F \to 0$. Now $k \otimes F = k^n$ is an n-dimensional vector space over k; $1 \otimes \varphi$ is surjective, hence bijective, hence $k \otimes N = 0$.

Also N is finitely generated, by Chapter 2, Exercise 12, hence $N = 0$ by Nakayama's lemma. Hence φ is an isomorphism.]

Deduce that every set of generators of F has at least n elements.

Exercise 3.16. Let B be a flat A-algebra. Then the following conditions are equivalent:

i) $a^{ec} = a$ for all ideals a of A.
ii) $\mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is surjective.
iii) For every maximal ideal m of A we have $m^e \neq (1)$.
iv) If M is any non-zero A-module, then $M_B \neq 0$.
v) For every A-module M, the mapping $x \mapsto 1 \otimes x$ of M into M_B is injective.

[For i) $\Rightarrow$ ii), use (3.16). ii) $\Rightarrow$ iii) is clear. iii) $\Rightarrow$ iv): Let x be a non-zero element of M and let $M' = Ax$. Since B is flat over A it is enough to show that $M'_B \neq 0$. We have $M' \cong A/a$ for some ideal $a \neq (1)$. Since B is flat over A, $M'_B \cong B/a^e$. Now $a \subseteq m$ for some maximal ideal m, hence $a^e \subseteq m^e \neq (1)$. Hence $M'_B \neq 0$.

iv) $\Rightarrow$ v): Let M' be the kernel of $M \to M_B$. But (Chapter 2, Exercise 13, with $N = M_B$) the mapping $M'_B \to M_B$ is injective. Hence $M'_B = 0$ and therefore $M' = 0$.

v) $\Rightarrow$ i): Take $M = A/a$.]

B is said to be **faithfully flat** over A.

Exercise 3.17. Let $A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C$ be ring homomorphisms. If $g \circ f$ is flat and g is faithfully flat, then f is flat.

Exercise 3.18. Let $f : A \to B$ be a flat homomorphism of rings, let q be a prime ideal of B and let $p = q^c$. Then $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B_q) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A_p)$ is surjective. [For B_p is flat over A_p by (3.10), and B_q is a local ring of B_p, hence flat over B_p by (3.10). Hence B_q is flat over A_p and satisfies condition (3) of Exercise 16.]

Exercise 3.19. Let A be a ring, M an A-module. The **support** of M is defined to be the set $\mathrm{Supp}(M)$ of prime ideals p of A such that $M_p \neq 0$. Prove the following results:

i) $M \neq 0 \Leftrightarrow \mathrm{Supp}(M) \neq \emptyset$.
ii) $V(a) = \mathrm{Supp}(A/a)$.
iii) If $0 \to M' \to M \to M'' \to 0$ is an exact sequence, then $\mathrm{Supp}(M) = \mathrm{Supp}(M') \cup \mathrm{Supp}(M'')$.
iv) If $M = \sum_i M_i$, then $\mathrm{Supp}(M) = \cup_i \mathrm{Supp}(M_i)$.
v) If M, N are finitely generated, then $\mathrm{Supp}(M \otimes_A N) = \mathrm{Supp}(M) \cap \mathrm{Supp}(N)$. [Use Chapter 2, Exercise 3.]
vi) If M is finitely generated, then $\mathrm{Supp}(M) = V(\mathrm{Ann}(M))$ (and is therefore a closed subset of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$).
vii) If M is finitely generated and a is an ideal of A, then $\mathrm{Supp}(M/aM) = V(a + \mathrm{Ann}(M))$.
viii) If $f : A \to B$ is a ring homomorphism and M is a finitely generated A-module, then $\mathrm{Supp}(B \otimes_A M) = f^{*-1}(\mathrm{Supp}(M))$.

Exercise 3.20. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism, $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ the associated mapping. Show that
i) Every prime ideal of A is a contracted ideal $\Leftrightarrow$ f^* is surjective.
ii) Every prime ideal of B is an extended ideal $\Rightarrow$ f^* is injective.

Is the converse of ii) true?

Exercise 3.21.
i) Let A be a ring, S a multiplicatively closed subset of A, and $\varphi : A \to S^{-1}A$ the canonical homomorphism. Show that $\varphi^* : \mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}A) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a homeomorphism of $\mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}A)$ onto its image in $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$. Let this image be denoted by $S^{-1}X$.

In particular, if $f \in A$, the image of $\mathrm{Spec}(A_f)$ in X is the basic open set X_f (Chapter 1, Exercise 17).

i) Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism. Let $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ and $Y = \mathrm{Spec}(B)$, and let $f^* : Y \to X$ be the mapping associated with f. Identifying $\mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}A)$ with its canonical image $S^{-1}X$ in X, and $\mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}B)$ $(= \mathrm{Spec}((f(S))^{-1}B))$ with its canonical image $S^{-1}Y$ in Y, show that $S^{-1}f^*$: $\mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}A)$ is the restriction of f^* to $S^{-1}Y$, and that $S^{-1}Y = f^{*-1}(S^{-1}X)$.

ii) Let a be an ideal of A and let $b = a^e$ be its extension in B. Let $\overline{f} : A/a \to B/b$ be the homomorphism induced by f. If $\mathrm{Spec}(A/a)$ is identified with its canonical image $V(a)$ in X, and $\mathrm{Spec}(B/b)$ with its canonical image $V(b)$ in Y, show that $\overline{f}^*$ is the restriction of f^* to $V(b)$.

iii) Let p be a prime ideal of A. Take $S = A - p$ in ii) and then reduce mod $S^{-1}p$ as in iii). Deduce that the subspace $f^{*-1}(p)$ of Y is naturally homeomorphic to $\mathrm{Spec}(B_p/pB_p) = \mathrm{Spec}(k(p) \otimes_A B)$, where $k(p)$ is the residue field of the local ring A_p.

$\mathrm{Spec}(k(p) \otimes_A B)$ is called the **fiber** of f^* over p.

Exercise 3.22. Let A be a ring and p a prime ideal of A. Then the canonical image of $\mathrm{Spec}(A_p)$ in $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is equal to the intersection of all the open neighborhoods of p in $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$.

Exercise 3.23. Let A be a ring, let $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ and let U be a basic open set in X (i.e., $U = X_f$ for some $f \in A$: Chapter 1, Exercise 17).

i) If $U = X_f$, show that the ring $A(U) = A_f$ depends only on U and not on f.

ii) Let $U' = X_g$ be another basic open set such that $U' \subseteq U$. Show that there is an equation of the form $g^n = uf$ for some integer $n > 0$ and some $u \in A$, and use this to define a homomorphism $\rho : A(U) \to A(U')$ (i.e., $A_f \to A_g$) by mapping a/f^m to au^m/g^{mn}. Show that ρ depends only on U and U'. This homomorphism is called the **restriction** homomorphism.

iii) If $U = U'$, then ρ is the identity map.

iv) If $U \supseteq U' \supseteq U''$ are basic open sets in X, show that restricting from U to U'' directly agrees with restricting first from U to U' and then from U' to U'' (i.e., the restriction homomorphisms compose consistently).

v) Let $x(= p)$ be a point of X. Show that

$$\lim_{U \ni x} A(U) \cong A_p.$$

The assignment of the ring $A(U)$ to each basic open set U of X, and the restriction homomorphisms ρ, satisfying the conditions iii) and iv) above, constitutes a **presheaf of rings** on the basis of open sets $\big(X_f\big)_{f \in A}$. v) says that the stalk of this presheaf at $x \in X$ is the corresponding local ring A_p.

Exercise 3.24. Show that the presheaf of Exercise 23 has the following property. Let $(U_i)_{i \in I}$ be a covering of X by basic open sets. For each $i \in I$ let $s_i \in A(U_i)$ be such that, for each pair of indices i, j, the images of s_i and s_j in $A\big(U_i \cap U_j\big)$ are equal. Then there exists a unique $s \in A(= A(X))$ whose image in $A(U_i)$ is s_i, for all $i \in I$. (This essentially implies that the presheaf is a **sheaf**.)

Exercise 3.25. Let $f : A \to B$, $g : A \to C$ be ring homomorphisms and let $h : A \to B \otimes_A C$ be defined by $h(x) = f(x) \otimes g(x)$. Let X, Y, Z, T be the prime spectra of $A, B, C, B \otimes_A C$ respectively. Then $h^*(T) = f^*(Y) \cap g^*(Z)$.

[Let $p \in X$, and let $k = k(p)$ be the residue field at p. By Exercise 21, the fiber $h^{*-1}(p)$ is the spectrum of $(B \otimes_A C) \otimes_A k \cong (B \otimes_A k) \otimes_k (C \otimes_A k)$. Hence $p \in h^*(T) \Leftrightarrow (B \otimes_A k) \otimes_k (C \otimes_A k) \neq 0 \Leftrightarrow B \otimes_A k \neq 0$ and $C \otimes_A k \neq 0 \Leftrightarrow p \in f^*(Y) \cap g^*(Z)$.]

Exercise 3.26. Let $\big(A_\alpha, g_{\alpha\beta}\big)$ be a direct system of rings and B the direct limit. For each α, let $f_\alpha : A_\alpha \to B_\alpha$ be a ring homomorphism such that $g_{\alpha\beta} \circ f_\alpha = f_\beta$ whenever $\alpha \leq \beta$ (i.e. the B_α form a direct system of A-algebras). The f_α induce $f : A \to B$. Show that

$$f^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B)) = \cap_\alpha \, f_\alpha^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B_\alpha)).$$

[Let $p \in \mathrm{Spec}(A)$. Then $f^{*-1}(p)$ is the spectrum of

$$B \otimes_A k(p) \cong \varinjlim (B_\alpha \otimes_A k(p))$$

(since tensor products commute with direct limits: Chapter 2, Exercise 20). By Exercise 21 of Chapter 2 it follows that $f^{*-1}(p) = \emptyset$ if and only if $B_\alpha \otimes_A k(p) = 0$ for some α, i.e., if and only if $f_\alpha^{*-1}(p) = \emptyset$.]

Exercise 3.27.

i) Let $f_\alpha : A \to B_\alpha$ be any family of A-algebras and let $f : A \to B$ be their tensor product over A (Chapter 2, Exercise 23). Then

$$f^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B)) = \cap_\alpha \, f_\alpha^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B_\alpha)).$$

[Use Exercises 25 and 26.]

ii) Let $f_\alpha : A \to B_\alpha$ be any finite family of A-algebras and let $B = \prod_\alpha B_\alpha$. Define $f : A \to B$ by $f(x) = (f_\alpha(x))$. Then $f^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B)) = \cup_\alpha \, f_\alpha^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B_\alpha))$.

iii) Hence the subsets of $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ of the form $f^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B))$, where $f : A \to B$ is a ring homomorphism, satisfy the axioms for closed sets in a topological space. The associated topology is the **constructible** topology on X. It is finer than the Zariski topology (i.e., there are more open sets and, or equivalently more closed sets).

iv) Let X_C denote the set X endowed with the constructible topology. Show that X_C is quasi-compact.

Exercise 3.28. (Continuation of Exercise 27.)

i) For each $g \in A$, the set X_g (Chapter 1, Exercise 17) is both open and closed in the constructible topology.

ii) Let C' denote the smallest topology on X for which the sets X_g are both open and closed, and let $X_{C'}$ denote the set X endowed with this topology. Show that $X_{C'}$ is Hausdorff.

iii) Deduce that the identity mapping $X_C \to X_{C'}$ is a homeomorphism. Hence a subset E of X is of the form $f^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B))$ for some $f : A \to B$ if and only if it is closed in the topology C'.

iv) The topological space X_C is compact, Hausdorff and totally disconnected.

Exercise 3.29. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism. Show that $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a continuous **closed** mapping (i.e., maps closed sets to closed sets) for the constructible topology.

Exercise 3.30. Show that the Zariski topology and the constructible topology on $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ are the same if and only if $A/\mathfrak{n}$ is absolutely flat (where $\mathfrak{n}$ is the nilradical of A). [Use Exercise 11.]

4 Primary Decomposition

Exercise 4.1. If an ideal a has a primary decomposition, then $\mathrm{Spec}(A/a)$ has only finitely many irreducible components.

Exercise 4.2. If $a = r(a)$, then a has no embedded prime ideals.

Exercise 4.3. If A is absolutely flat, every primary ideal is maximal.

Exercise 4.4. In the polynomial ring $\mathbb{Z}[t]$, the ideal $m = (2, t)$ is maximal and the ideal $q = (4, t)$ is m-primary, but is not a power of m.

Exercise 4.5. In the polynomial ring $K[x, y, z]$ where K is a field and x, y, z are independent indeterminates, let $p_1 = (x, y)$, $p_2 = (x, z)$, $m = (x, y, z)$; p_1 and p_2 are prime, and m is maximal.

Let $a = p_1 p_2$. Show that $a = p_1 \cap p_2 \cap m^2$ is a reduced primary decomposition of a. Which components are isolated and which are embedded?

Exercise 4.6. Let X be an infinite compact Hausdorff space, $C(X)$ the ring of real-valued continuous functions on X (Chapter 1, Exercise 26). Is the zero ideal decomposable in this ring?

Exercise 4.7. Let A be a ring and let $A[x]$ denote the ring of polynomials in one indeterminate over A. For each ideal a of A, let $a[x]$ denote the set of all polynomials in $A[x]$ with coefficients in a.

i) $a[x]$ is the extension of a to $A[x]$.
ii) If p is a prime ideal in A, then $p[x]$ is a prime ideal in $A[x]$.
iii) If q is a p-primary ideal in A, then $q[x]$ is a $p[x]$-primary ideal in $A[x]$. [Use Chapter 1, Exercise 2.]
iv) If $a = \cap_{i=1}^{n} q_i$ is a minimal primary decomposition in A, then $a[x] = \cap_{i=1}^{n} q_i[x]$ is a minimal primary decomposition in $A[x]$.
v) If p is a minimal prime ideal of a, then $p[x]$ is a minimal prime ideal of $a[x]$.

Exercise 4.8. Let k be a field. Show that in the polynomial ring $k[x_1, ..., x_n]$ the ideals $p_i = (x_1, ..., x_i)$ $(1 \leq i \leq n)$ are prime and all their powers are primary. [Use Exercise 7.]

Exercise 4.9. In a ring A, let $D(A)$ denote the set of prime ideals p which satisfy the following condition: there exists $a \in A$ such that p is minimal in the set of prime ideals containing $(0 : a)$. Show that $x \in A$ is a zero divisor $\Leftrightarrow x \in p$ for some $p \in D(A)$.

Let S be a multiplicatively closed subset of A, and identify $\mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}A)$ with its image in $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ (Chapter 3, Exercise 21). Show that

$$D(S^{-1}A) = D(A) \cap \mathrm{Spec}(S^{-1}A).$$

If the zero ideal has a primary decomposition, show that $D(A)$ is the set of associated prime ideals of 0.

Exercise 4.10. For any prime ideal p in a ring A, let $S_p(0)$ denote the kernel of the homomorphism $A \to A_p$.

i) $S_p(0) \subseteq p$.
ii) $r\big(S_p(0)\big) = p \Leftrightarrow p$ is a minimal prime ideal of A.
iii) If $p \supseteq p'$, then $S_p(0) \subseteq S_{p'}(0)$.
iv) $\cap_{p \in D(A)} S_p(0) = 0$, where $D(A)$ is defined in Exercise 9.

Exercise 4.11. If p is a minimal prime ideal of a ring A, show that $S_p(0)$ (Exercise 10) is the smallest p-primary ideal.

Let a be the intersection of the ideals $S_p(0)$ as p runs through the minimal prime ideals of A. Show that a is contained in the nilradical of A.

Suppose that the zero ideal is decomposable. Prove that $a = 0$ if and only if every prime ideal of 0 is isolated.

Exercise 4.12. Let A be a ring, S a multiplicatively closed subset of A. For any ideal a, let $S(a)$ denote the contraction of $S^{-1}a$ in A. The ideal $S(a)$ is called the **saturation** of a with respect to S. Prove that

i) $S(a) \cap S(b) = S(a \cap b)$
ii) $S(r(a)) = r(S(a))$
iii) $S(a) = (1) \Leftrightarrow a$ meets S
iv) $S_1(S_2(a)) = (S_1 S_2)(a)$.

If a has a primary decomposition, prove that the set of ideals $S(a)$ (where S runs through multiplicatively closed subsets of A) is finite.

Exercise 4.13. Let A be a ring and p a prime ideal of A. The ***n*th symbolic power** of p is defined to be the ideal (in the notation of Exercise 12)

$$p^{(n)} = S_p(p^n)$$

where $S_p = A - p$. Show that

i) $p^{(n)}$ is a p-primary ideal;
ii) if p^n has a primary decomposition, then $p^{(n)}$ is its p-primary component;
iii) if $p^{(m)}p^{(n)}$ has a primary decomposition, then $p^{(m+n)}$ is its p-primary component;
iv) $p^{(n)} = p^n \Leftrightarrow p^{(n)}$ is p-primary.

Exercise 4.14. Let a be a decomposable ideal in a ring A and let p be a maximal element of the set of ideals $(a : x)$, where $x \in A$ and $x \notin a$. Show that p is a prime ideal belonging to a.

Exercise 4.15. Let a be a decomposable ideal in a ring A, let Σ be an isolated set of prime ideals belonging to a, and let q_Σ be the intersection of the corresponding primary components. Let f be an element of A such that, for each prime ideal p belonging to a, we have $f \in p \Leftrightarrow p \notin \Sigma$, and let S_f be the set of all powers of f. Show that

$$q_\Sigma = S_f(a) = (a : f^n)$$

for all large n.

Exercise 4.16. If A is a ring in which every ideal has a primary decomposition, show that every ring of fractions $S^{-1}A$ has the same property.

Exercise 4.17. Let A be a ring with the following property:

(L1) For every ideal $a \neq (1)$ in A and every prime ideal p, there exists $x \notin p$ such that $S_p(a) = (a : x)$.

Then every ideal in A is an intersection of (possibly infinitely many) primary ideals.

[Let a be an ideal $\neq (1)$ in A, and let p_1 be a minimal element of the set of prime ideals containing a. Then $q_1 = S_{p_1}(a)$ is p_1-primary (by Exercise 11), and $q_1 = (a : x)$ for some $x \notin p_1$. Show that $a = q_1 \cap (a + (x))$.

Now let a_1 be a maximal element of the set of ideals $b \supseteq a$ such that $q_1 \cap b = a$, and choose a_1 so that $x \in a_1$, and therefore $a_1 \not\subset p_1$. Repeat the construction starting with a_1, and so on. At the nth stage we have $a = q_1 \cap ... \cap q_n \cap a_n$ where the q_i are primary ideals, a_n is maximal among the ideals $b \supseteq a_{n-1} = a_n \cap q_n$ such that $a = q_1 \cap ... \cap q_n \cap b$, and $a_n \not\subset p_n$. If at any stage we have $a_n = (1)$, the process stops, and a is a finite intersection of primary ideals. If not, continue by transfinite induction, observing that each a_n strictly contains a_{n-1}.]

Exercise 4.18. Consider the following condition on a ring A:

(L2) Given an ideal a and a descending chain $S_1 \supseteq S_2 \supseteq ... \supseteq S_n \supseteq ...$ of multiplicatively closed subsets of A, there exists an integer n such that $S_n(a) = S_{n+1}(a) = ...$

Prove that the following are equivalent:
i) Every ideal in A has a primary decomposition;
ii) A satisfies (L1) and (L2).

[For i) $\Rightarrow$ ii), use Exercises 12 and 15. For ii) $\Rightarrow$ i) show, with the notation of the proof of Exercise 17, that if $S_n = S_{p_1} \cap ... \cap S_{p_n}$ then S_n meets a_n, hence $S_n(a_n) = (1)$, and therefore $S_n(a) = q_1 \cap ... \cap q_n$. Now use (L2) to show that the construction must terminate after a finite number of steps.]

Exercise 4.19. Let A be a ring and p a prime ideal of A. Show that every p-primary ideal of A contains $S_p(0)$, the kernel of the canonical homomorphism $A \to A_p$.

Suppose that A satisfies the following condition: for every prime ideal p, the intersection of all p -primary ideals of A is equal to $S_p(0)$. (Noetherian rings satisfy this condition: see Chapter 10.) Let $p_1, ..., p_n$ be distinct prime ideals, none of which is a minimal prime ideal of A. Then there exists an ideal a in A whose associated prime ideals are $p_1, ..., p_n$.

[Proof by induction on n. The case $n = 1$ is trivial (take $a = p_1$). Suppose $n > 1$ and let p_n be maximal in the set $\{p_1, ..., p_n\}$. By the inductive hypothesis there exists an ideal b and a minimal primary decomposition $b = q_1 \cap ... \cap q_{n-1}$, where each q_i is p_i-primary. If $b \subseteq S_{p_n}(0)$, let p be a minimal prime ideal of A contained in p_n. Then $S_{p_n}(0) \subseteq S_p(0)$, hence $b \subseteq S_p(0)$. Taking radicals and using Exercise 10, we have $p_1 \cap ... \cap p_{n-1} \subseteq p$, hence some $p_i \subseteq p$, hence $p_i = p$ since p is minimal. This is a contradiction since no p_i is minimal. Hence $b \not\subset S_{p_n}(0)$ and therefore there exists a p_n-primary ideal q_n such that $b \not\subset q_n$. Show that $a = q_1 \cap ... \cap q_n$ has the required properties.]

4.1 Primary decomposition of modules

Practically the whole of this chapter can be transposed to the context of modules over a ring A. The following exercises indicate how this is done.

Exercise 4.20. Let M be a fixed A-module, N a submodule of M. The **radical** of N in M is defined to be

$$r_M(N) = \{x \in A : x^q M \subseteq N \text{ for some } q > 0\}.$$

Show that $r_M(N) = r(N : M) = r(\text{Ann}(M/N))$. In particular, $r_M(N)$ is an ideal.

State and prove the formulas for r_M analogous to (1.13).

Exercise 4.21. An element $x \in A$ defines an endomorphism φ_x of M, namely $m \mapsto xm$. The element x is said to be a **zero-divisor** (resp. **nilpotent**) in M if φ_x is not injective (resp. is nilpotent). A submodule Q of M is **primary in M** if $Q \neq M$ and every zero-divisor in M/Q is nilpotent.

Show that if Q is primary in M, then $(Q : M)$ is a primary ideal and hence $r_M(Q)$ is a prime ideal p. We say that Q is p-primary (in M).

Prove the analogues of (4.3) and (4.4).

Exercise 4.22. A **primary decomposition** of N in M is a representation of N as an intersection

$$N = Q_1 \cap \ldots \cap Q_n$$

of primary submodules of M; it is a **minimal primary decomposition** if the ideals $p_i = r_M(Q_i)$ are all distinct and if none of the components Q_i can be omitted from the intersection, that is if $Q_i \not\subset \cap_{j \neq i} Q_j$ $(1 \leq i \leq n)$.

Prove the analogue of (4.5), that the prime ideals p_i depend only on N (and M). They are called the **prime ideals belonging to** N in M. Show that they are also the prime ideals belonging to 0 in M/N.

Exercise 4.23. State and prove the analogues of (4.6)–(4.11) inclusive. (There is no loss of generality in taking $N = 0$.)

5 Integral Dependence and Valuations

Exercise 5.1. Let $f : A \to B$ be an integral homomorphism of rings. Show that $f^* : \text{Spec}(B) \to \text{Spec}(A)$ is a **closed** mapping, i.e. that it maps closed sets to closed sets. (This is a geometrical equivalent of (5.10).)

Exercise 5.2. Let A be a subring of a ring B such that B is integral over A, and let $f : A \to \Omega$ be a homomorphism of A into an algebraically closed field Ω. Show that f can be extended to a homomorphism of B into Ω. [Use (5.10).]

Exercise 5.3. Let $f : B \to B'$ be a homomorphism of A-algebras, and let C be an A-algebra. If f is integral, prove that $f \otimes 1 : B \otimes_A C \to B' \otimes_A C$ is integral. (This includes (5.6) ii) as a special case.)

Exercise 5.4. Let A be a subring of a ring B such that B is integral over A. Let m be a maximal ideal of B and let $n = m \cap A$ be the corresponding maximal ideal of A. Is B_n necessarily integral over A_n?

[Consider the subring $k[x^2-1]$ of $k[x]$, where k is a field, and let $n=(x-1)$. Can the element $1/(x+1)$ be integral?]

Exercise 5.5. Let $A \subseteq B$ be rings, B integral over A.

i) If $x \in A$ is a unit in B then it is a unit in A.

ii) The Jacobson radical of A is the contraction of the Jacobson radical of B.

Exercise 5.6. Let $B_1, ..., B_n$ be integral A-algebras. Show that $\prod_{i=1}^{n} B_i$ is an integral A-algebra.

Exercise 5.7. Let A be a subring of a ring B, such that the set $B-A$ is closed under multiplication. Show that A is integrally closed in B.

Exercise 5.8.

i) Let A be a subring of an integral domain B, and let C be the integral closure of A in B. Let f, g be monic polynomials in $B[x]$ such that $fg \in C[x]$. Then f, g are in $C[x]$. [Take a field containing B in which the polynomials f, g split into linear factors: say $f = \prod(x-\xi_i)$, $g = \prod(x-\eta_j)$. Each ξ_i and each η_j is a root of fg, hence is integral over C. Hence the coefficients of f and g are integral over C.]

ii) Prove the same result without assuming that B (or A) is an integral domain.

Exercise 5.9. Let A be a subring of a ring B and let C be the integral closure of A in B. Prove that $C[x]$ is the integral closure of $A[x]$ in $B[x]$. [If $f \in B[x]$ is integral over $A[x]$, then

$$f^m + g_1 f^{m-1} + ... + g_m = 0 \quad (g_i \in A[x]).$$

Let r be an integer larger than m and the degrees of $g_1, ..., g_m$, and let $f_1 = f - x^r$, so that

$$(f_1 + x^r)^m + g_1(f_1 + x^r)^{m-1} + ... + g_m = 0$$

or say

$$f_1^m + h_1 f_1^{m-1} + ... + h_m = 0,$$

where $h_m = (x^r)^m + g_1(x^r)^{m-1} + ... + g_m \in A[x]$. Now apply Exercise 8 to the polynomials $-f_1$ and $f_1^{m-1} + h_1 f_1^{m-2} + ... + h_{m-1}$.]

Exercise 5.10. A ring homomorphism $f : A \to B$ is said to have the **going-up property** (resp. the **going-down property**) if the conclusion of the going-up theorem (5.11) (resp. the going-down theorem (5.16)) holds for B and the subring $f(A)$.

Let $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ be the mapping associated with f.

i) Consider the following statements: (a) f^* is a closed mapping. (b) f has the going-up property. (c) Let q be any prime ideal of B and let $p = q^c$. Then $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B/q) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A/p)$ is surjective. Prove that (a) $\Rightarrow$ (b) $\Leftrightarrow$ (c). (See also Chapter 6, Exercise 11.)

ii) Consider the following three statements: (a') f^* is an open mapping. (b') f has the going-down property. (c') For any prime ideal q of B, if $p = q^c$, then $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B_q) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A_p)$ is surjective. Prove that (a') $\Rightarrow$ (c') $\Leftrightarrow$ (b').

[To prove (a') ⇒ (c'), observe that B_q is the direct limit of the rings B_t where $t \in B - q$; hence, by Chapter 3, Exercise 26, we have $f^*\big(\mathrm{Spec}\big(B_q\big)\big) = \cap_t\, f^*(\mathrm{Spec}(B_t)) = \cap_t\, f^*(Y_t)$. Since Y_t is an open neighborhood of q in Y, and since f^* is open, it follows that $f^*(Y_t)$ is an open neighborhood of p in X and therefore contains $\mathrm{Spec}\big(A_p\big)$.]

Exercise 5.11. Let $f : A \to B$ be a flat homomorphism of rings. Then f has the going-down property. [Chapter 3, Exercise 18.]

Exercise 5.12. Let G be a finite group of automorphisms of a ring A, and let A^G denote the subring of G-invariants, that is of all $x \in A$ such that $\sigma(x) = x$ for all $\sigma \in G$. Prove that A is integral over A^G. [If $x \in A$, observe that x is a root of the polynomial $\prod_{\sigma \in G}(t - \sigma(x))$.]

Let S be a multiplicatively closed subset of A such that $\sigma(S) \subseteq S$ for all $\sigma \in G$, and let $S^G = S \cap A^G$. Show that the action of G on A extends to an action on $S^{-1}A$, and that $\big(S^G\big)^{-1}A^G \cong \big(S^{-1}A\big)^G$.

Exercise 5.13. In the situation of Exercise 12, let p be a prime ideal of A^G, and let P be the set of prime ideals of A whose contraction is p. Show that G acts transitively on P. In particular, P is finite.

[Let $p_1, p_2 \in P$ and let $x \in p_1$. Then $\prod_\sigma \sigma(x) \in p_1 \cap A^G = p \subseteq p_2$, hence $\sigma(x) \in p_2$ for some $\sigma \in G$. Deduce that p_1 is contained in $\cup_{\sigma \in G}\, \sigma(p_2)$, and then apply (1.11) and (5.9).]

Exercise 5.14. Let A be an integrally closed domain, K its field of fractions and L a finite normal separable extension of K. Let G be the Galois group of L over K and let B be the integral closure of A in L. Show that $\sigma(B) = B$ for all $\sigma \in G$, and that $A = B^G$.

Exercise 5.15. Let A, K be as in Exercise 14, let L be any finite extension field of K, and let B be the integral closure of A in L. Show that, if p is any prime ideal of A, then the set of prime ideals q of B which contract to p is finite (in other words, that $\mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ has finite fibers).

[Reduce to the two cases (a) L separable over K and (b) L purely inseparable over K. In case (a), embed L in a finite normal separable extension of K, and use Exercises 13 and 14. In case (b), if q is a prime ideal of B such that $q \cap A = p$, show that q is the set of all $x \in B$ such that $x^{p^m} \in p$ for some $m \geq 0$, where p is the characteristic of K, and hence that $\mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is bijective in this case.]

5.1 Noether's normalization lemma

Exercise 5.16. Let k be a field and let $A \neq 0$ be a finitely generated k-algebra. Then there exist elements $y_1, ..., y_r \in A$ which are algebraically independent over k and such that A is integral over $k[y_1, ..., y_r]$. (The result is still true if k is finite, but a different proof is needed.)

We shall assume that k is **infinite**. Let $x_1, ..., x_n$ generate A as a k-algebra. We can renumber the x_i so that $x_1, ..., x_r$ are algebraically independent over k and each of $x_{r+1}, ..., x_n$ is algebraic over $k[x_1, ..., x_r]$. Now proceed by induction on n. If $n = r$ there is nothing to do, so suppose $n > r$ and the result true for $n - 1$ generators. Let x_n be algebraic over $k[x_1, ..., x_{n-1}]$, then there exists a polynomial $f \neq 0$ in n variables such that $f(x_1, ..., x_{n-1}, x_n) = 0$. Let F be the homogeneous part

of highest degree in f. Since k is infinite, there exist $\lambda_1, ..., \lambda_{n-1} \in k$ such that $F(\lambda_1, ..., \lambda_{n-1}, 1) \neq 0$. Put $x_i' = x_i - \lambda_i x_n$ $(1 \leq i \leq n-1)$. Show that x_n is integral over the ring $A' = k[x_1', ..., x_{n-1}']$, and hence that A is integral over A'. Then apply the inductive hypothesis to A' to complete the proof.

From the proof it follows that $y_1, ..., y_r$ may be chosen to be linear combinations of $x_1, ..., x_n$. This has the following geometrical interpretation: if k is algebraically closed and X is an affine algebraic variety in k^n with coordinate ring $A \neq 0$, then there exists a linear subspace L of dimension r in k^n and a linear mapping of k^n onto L which maps X onto L. [Use Exercise 2.]

5.2 Nullstellensatz (weak form)

Exercise 5.17. Let X be an affine algebraic variety in k^n, where k is an algebraically closed field, and let $I(X)$ be the ideal of X in the polynomial ring $k[t_1, ..., t_n]$ (Chapter 1, Exercise 27). If $I(X) \neq (1)$ then X is not empty. [Let $A = k[t_1, ..., t_n]/I(X)$ be the coordinate ring of X. Then $A \neq 0$, hence by Exercise 16 there exists a linear subspace L of dimension ≥ 0 in k^n and a mapping of X onto L. Hence $X \neq \emptyset$.]

Deduce that every maximal ideal in the ring $k[t_1, ..., t_n]$ is of the form $(t_1 - a_1, ..., t_n - a_n)$ where $a_i \in k$.

Exercise 5.18. Let k be a field and let B be a finitely generated k-algebra. Suppose that B is a field. Then B is a finite algebraic extension of k. (This is another version of Hilbert's Nullstellensatz. For other proofs, see (5.24), (7.9).)

Let $x_1, ..., x_n$ generate B as a k-algebra. The proof is by induction on n. If $n = 1$ the result is clearly true, so assume $n > 1$. Let $A = k[x_1]$ and let $K = k(x_1)$ be the field of fractions of A. By the inductive hypothesis, B is a finite algebraic extension of K, hence each $x_2, ..., x_n$ satisfies a monic polynomial equation with coefficients in K, i.e. coefficients of the form a/b where a and b are in A. If f is the product of the denominators of all these coefficients, then each of $x_2, ..., x_n$ is integral over A_f. Hence B and therefore K is integral over A_f.

Suppose x_1 is transcendental over k. Then A is integrally closed, because it is a unique factorization domain. Hence A_f is integrally closed (5.12), and therefore $A_f = K$, which is clearly absurd. Hence x_1 is algebraic over k, hence K (and therefore B) is a finite extension of k.

Exercise 5.19. Deduce the result of Exercise 17 from Exercise 18.

Exercise 5.20. Let A be a subring of an integral domain B such that B is finitely generated over A. Show that there exists $s \neq 0$ in A and elements $y_1, ..., y_n$ in B, algebraically independent over A and such that B_s is integral over B_s', where $B' = A[y_1, ..., y_n]$.

[Let $S = A - \{0\}$ and let $K = S^{-1}A$. Then $S^{-1}B$ is a finitely generated K-algebra and therefore by the normalization lemma (Exercise 16) there exist $x_1, ..., x_n$ in $S^{-1}B$, algebraically independent over K and such that $S^{-1}B$ is integral over $K[x_1, ..., x_n]$. Let $z_1, ..., z_m$ generate B as an A-algebra. Then each z_j (regarded as an element of $S^{-1}B$) is integral over $K[x_1, ..., x_n]$. By writing an equation of integral dependence for each z_j, show that there exists $s \in S$ such that $x_i = y_i/s$

$(1 \leq i \leq n)$ with $y_i \in B$, and such that each sz_j is integral over B'. Deduce that this s satisfies the conditions stated.]

Exercise 5.21. Let A, B be as in Exercise 20. Show that there exists $s \neq 0$ in A such that, if Ω is an algebraically closed field and $f : A \to \Omega$ is a homomorphism for which $f(s) \neq 0$, then f can be extended to a homomorphism $B \to \Omega$.

[With the notation of Exercise 20, f can be extended first of all to B', for example by mapping each y_i to 0; then to B'_s (because $f(s) \neq 0$), and finally to B_s (by Exercise 2, because B_s is integral over B'_s).]

Exercise 5.22. Let A, B be as in Exercise 20. If the Jacobson radical of A is zero, then so is the Jacobson radical of B.

[Let $v \neq 0$ be an element of B. We have to show that there is a maximal ideal of B which does not contain v. By applying Exercise 21 to the ring B_v and its subring A, we obtain an element $s \neq 0$ in A. Let m be a maximal ideal of A such that $s \notin m$, and let $k = A/m$. Then the canonical mapping $A \to k$ extends to a homomorphism g of B_v into an algebraic closure Ω of k. Then $g(v) \neq 0$ and $\ker(g) \cap B$ is a maximal ideal of B.]

Exercise 5.23. Let A be a ring. Show that the following are equivalent:

i) Every prime ideal in A is an intersection of maximal ideals.

ii) In every homomorphic image of A the nilradical is equal to the Jacobson radical.

iii) Every prime ideal in A which is not maximal is equal to the intersection of the prime ideals which contain it strictly.

[The only hard part is iii) $\Rightarrow$ ii). Suppose ii) false, then there is a prime ideal which is not an intersection of maximal ideals. Passing to the quotient ring, we may assume that A is an integral domain whose Jacobson radical $\mathfrak{n}$ is not zero. Let f be a non-zero element of $\mathfrak{n}$. Then $A_f \neq 0$, hence A_f has a maximal ideal, whose contraction in A is a prime ideal p such that $f \notin p$, and which is maximal with respect to this property. Then p is not maximal and is not equal to the intersection of the prime ideals strictly containing p.]

A ring A with the three equivalent properties above is called a **Jacobson ring**.

Exercise 5.24. Let A be a Jacobson ring (Exercise 23) and B an A-algebra. Show that if B is either (i) integral over A or (ii) finitely generated as an A-algebra, then B is Jacobson. [Use Exercise 22 for (ii).]

In particular, every finitely generated ring, and every finitely generated algebra over a field, is a Jacobson ring.

Exercise 5.25. Let A be a ring. Show that the following are equivalent:

i) A is a Jacobson ring;

ii) Every finitely generated A-algebra B which is a field is finite over A.

[i) $\Rightarrow$ ii). Reduce to the case where A is a subring of B, and use Exercise 21. If $s \in A$ is as in Exercise 21, then there exists a maximal ideal m of A not containing s, and the homomorphism $A \to A/m = k$ extends to a homomorphism g of B into the algebraic closure of k. Since B is a field, g is injective, and $g(B)$ is algebraic over k, hence finite algebraic over k.

ii) $\Rightarrow$ i). Use criterion iii) of Exercise 23. Let p be a prime ideal of A which is not maximal, and let $B = A/p$. Let f be a non-zero element of B. Then B_f is a finitely generated A-algebra. If it is a field it is finite over B, hence integral over B and therefore B is a field (5.7). Hence B_f is not a field and therefore has a non-zero prime ideal, whose contraction in B is a non-zero ideal p' such that $f \notin p'$.]

Exercise 5.26. Let X be a topological space. A subset X_0 of X is **locally closed** if it is the intersection of an open set and a closed set, or equivalently if it is open in its closure.

The following conditions on a subset X_0 of X are equivalent: (1) Every non-empty locally closed subset of X meets X_0; (2) For every closed set E in X we have $\overline{E \cap X_0} = E$; (3) The mapping $U \mapsto U \cap X_0$ of the collection of open sets of X onto the collection of open sets of X_0 is bijective.

A subset X_0 satisfying these conditions is said to be **very dense** in X.

If A is a ring, show that the following are equivalent:
i) A is a Jacobson ring;
ii) The set of maximal ideals of A is very dense in $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$;
iii) Every locally closed subset of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ consisting of a single point is closed.

[ii) and iii) are geometrical formulations of conditions ii) and iii) of Exercise 23.]

5.3 Valuation rings and valuations

Exercise 5.27. Let A, B be two local rings. B is said to **dominate** A if A is a subring of B and the maximal ideal m of A is contained in the maximal ideal n of B (or, equivalently, if $m = n \cap A$). Let K be a field and let Σ be the set of all local subrings of K. If Σ is ordered by the relation of domination, show that Σ has maximal elements and that $A \in \Sigma$ is maximal if and only if A is a valuation ring of K. [Use (5.21).]

Exercise 5.28. Let A be an integral domain, K its field of fractions. Show that the following are equivalent: (1) A is a valuation ring of K; (2) If a, b are any two ideals of A, then either $a \subseteq b$ or $b \subseteq a$.

Deduce that if A is a valuation ring and p is a prime ideal of A, then A_p and A/p are valuation rings of their fields of fractions.

Exercise 5.29. Let A be a valuation ring of a field K. Show that every subring of K which contains A is a local ring of A.

Exercise 5.30. Let A be a valuation ring of a field K. The group U of units of A is a subgroup of the multiplicative group K^* of K.

Let $\Gamma = K^*/U$. If $\xi, \eta \in \Gamma$ are represented by $x, y \in K$, define $\xi \geq \eta$ to mean $xy^{-1} \in A$. Show that this defines a total ordering on Γ which is compatible with the group structure (i.e., $\xi \geq \eta \Rightarrow \xi\omega \geq \eta\omega$ for all $\omega \in \Gamma$). In other words, Γ is a totally ordered abelian group. It is called the **value group** of A.

Let $v : K^* \to \Gamma$ be the canonical homomorphism. Show that $v(x+y) \geq \min(v(x), v(y))$ for all $x, y \in K^*$.

Exercise 5.31. Conversely, let Γ be a totally ordered abelian group (written **additively**), and let K be a field. A **valuation of K with values in Γ** is a mapping $v : K^* \to \Gamma$ such that (1) $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y)$, (2) $v(x+y) \geq \min(v(x), v(y))$, for all $x, y \in K^*$. Show that the set of elements $x \in K^*$ such that $v(x) \geq 0$ is a valuation ring of K. This ring is called the **valuation ring** of v, and the subgroup $v(K^*)$ of Γ is the **value group** of v.

Thus the concepts of valuation ring and valuation are essentially equivalent.

Exercise 5.32. Let Γ be a totally ordered abelian group. A subgroup Δ of Γ is **isolated** in Γ if, whenever $0 \leq \beta \leq \alpha$ and $\alpha \in \Delta$, we have $\beta \in \Delta$. Let A be a valuation ring of a field K, with value group Γ (Exercise 31). If p is a prime ideal of A, show that $v(A-p)$ is the set of elements ≥ 0 in an isolated subgroup Δ of Γ, and that the mapping so defined of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ into the set of isolated subgroups of Γ is bijective.

If p is a prime ideal of A, what are the value groups of the valuation rings A/p, A_p?

Exercise 5.33. Let Γ be a totally ordered abelian group. We shall show how to construct a field K and a valuation v of K with Γ as value group. Let k be any field and let $A = k[\Gamma]$ be the group algebra of Γ over k. By definition, A is freely generated as a k-vector space by elements x_α ($\alpha \in \Gamma$) such that $x_\alpha x_\beta = x_{\alpha+\beta}$. Show that A is an integral domain.

If $u = \lambda_1 x_{\alpha_1} + \ldots + \lambda_n x_{\alpha_n}$ is any non-zero element of A, where the λ_i are all $\neq 0$ and $\alpha_1 < \ldots < \alpha_n$, define $v_0(u)$ to be α_1. Show that $v_0 : A - \{0\} \to \Gamma$ satisfies conditions (1) and (2) of Exercise 31.

Let K be the field of fractions of A. Show that v_0 can be uniquely extended to a valuation v of K, and that the value group of v is precisely Γ.

Exercise 5.34. Let A be a valuation ring and K its field of fractions. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism such that $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a **closed** mapping. Then if $g : B \to K$ is any A-algebra homomorphism (i.e., if $g \circ f$ is the embedding of A in K) we have $g(B) = A$.

[Let $C = g(B)$; obviously $C \supseteq A$. Let n be a maximal ideal of C. Since f^* is closed, C_n dominates A_m, whence $A_m = A$. Also the local ring C_n dominates A_m. Hence by Exercise 27 we have $C_n = A$ and therefore $C \subseteq A$.]

Exercise 5.35. From Exercises 1 and 3 it follows that, if $f : A \to B$ is integral and C is any A-algebra, then the mapping $(f \otimes 1)^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B \otimes_A C) \to \mathrm{Spec}(C)$ is a closed map.

Conversely, suppose that $f : A \to B$ has this property and that B is an integral domain. Then f is integral. [Replacing A by its image in B, reduce to the case where $A \subseteq B$ and f is the injection.

Let K be the field of fractions of B and let A' be a valuation ring of K containing A. By (5.22) it is enough to show that A' contains B. By hypothesis, $\mathrm{Spec}(B \otimes_A A') \to \mathrm{Spec}(A')$ is a closed map. Apply the result of Exercise 34 to the homomorphism $B \otimes_A A' \to K$ defined by $b \otimes a' \mapsto ba'$. It follows that $ba' \in A'$ for all $b \in B$ and all $a' \in A'$; taking $a' = 1$, we have what we want.]

Show that the result just proved remains valid if B is a ring with only finitely many minimal prime ideals (e.g., if B is Noetherian). [Let p_i be the minimal prime ideals. Then each composite homomorphism $A \to B \to B/p_i$ is integral, hence $A \to \prod(B/p_i)$ is integral, hence $A \to B/\mathfrak{n}$ is integral (where $\mathfrak{n}$ is the nilradical of B), hence finally $A \to B$ is integral.]

6 Chain Conditions

Exercise 6.1. Let M be a Noetherian A-module and $u : M \to M$ a module homomorphism.
i) If u is surjective, then u is an isomorphism.
ii) If M is Artinian and u is injective, then again u is an isomorphism.

[For (i), consider the submodules $\ker(u^n)$; for (ii), the quotient modules $\mathrm{coker}(u^n)$.]

Exercise 6.2. Let M be an A-module. If every non-empty set of finitely generated submodules of M has a maximal element, then M is Noetherian.

Exercise 6.3. Let M be an A-module and let N_1, N_2 be submodules of M. If M/N_1 and M/N_2 are Noetherian, so is $M/(N_1 \cap N_2)$. Similarly with Artinian in place of Noetherian.

Exercise 6.4. Let M be a Noetherian A-module and let a be the annihilator of M in A. Prove that A/a is a Noetherian ring.

If we replace "Noetherian" by "Artinian" in this result, is it still true?

Exercise 6.5. A topological space X is said to be **Noetherian** if the open subsets of X satisfy the ascending chain condition (or, equivalently, the maximal condition). Since closed subsets are complements of open subsets, it comes to the same thing to say that the closed subsets of X satisfy the descending chain condition (or, equivalently, the minimal condition). Show that, if X is Noetherian, then every subspace of X is Noetherian, and that X is quasi-compact.

Exercise 6.6. Prove that the following are equivalent:
i) X is Noetherian.
ii) Every open subspace of X is quasi-compact.
iii) Every subspace of X is quasi-compact.

Exercise 6.7. A Noetherian space is a finite union of irreducible closed subspaces. [Consider the set Σ of closed subsets of X which are not finite unions of irreducible closed subspaces.] Hence the set of irreducible components of a Noetherian space is finite.

Exercise 6.8. If A is a Noetherian ring then $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a Noetherian topological space. Is the converse true?

Exercise 6.9. Deduce from Exercise 8 that the set of minimal prime ideals in a Noetherian ring is finite.

Exercise 6.10. If M is a Noetherian module (over an arbitrary ring A) then $\mathrm{Supp}(M)$ is a closed Noetherian subspace of $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$.

Exercise 6.11. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism and suppose that $\mathrm{Spec}(B)$ is a Noetherian space (Exercise 5). Prove that $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a closed mapping if and only if f has the going-up property (Chapter 5, Exercise 10).

Exercise 6.12. Let A be a ring such that $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is a Noetherian space. Show that the set of prime ideals of A satisfies the ascending chain condition. Is the converse true?

7 Noetherian Rings

Exercise 7.1. Let A be a non-Noetherian ring and let Σ be the set of ideals in A which are not finitely generated. Show that Σ has maximal elements and that the maximal elements of Σ are prime ideals.

[Let a be a maximal element of Σ, and suppose that there exist $x, y \in A$ such that $x \notin a$ and $y \notin a$ and $xy \in a$. Show that there exists a finitely generated ideal $a_0 \subseteq a$ such that $a_0 + (x) = a + (x)$, and that $a = a_0 + x \cdot (a : x)$. Since $(a : x)$ strictly contains a, it is finitely generated and therefore so is a.]

Hence a ring in which every prime ideal is finitely generated is Noetherian (I. S. Cohen).

Exercise 7.2. Let A be a Noetherian ring and let $f = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n \in A[[x]]$. Prove that f is nilpotent if and only if each a_n is nilpotent.

Exercise 7.3. Let a be an irreducible ideal in a ring A. Then the following are equivalent:

i) a is primary;

ii) for every multiplicatively closed subset S of A we have $\left(S^{-1}a\right)^c = (a : x)$ for some $x \in S$;

iii) the sequence $(a : x^n)$ is stationary, for every $x \in A$.

Exercise 7.4. Which of the following rings are Noetherian?

i) The ring of rational functions of z having no pole on the circle $|z| = 1$.

ii) The ring of power series in z with a positive radius of convergence.

iii) The ring of power series in z with an infinite radius of convergence.

iv) The ring of polynomials in z whose first k derivatives vanish at the origin (k being a fixed integer).

v) The ring of polynomials in z, w all of whose partial derivatives with respect to w vanish for $z = 0$.

In all cases the coefficients are complex numbers.

Exercise 7.5. Let A be a Noetherian ring, B a finitely generated A-algebra, G a finite group of A-automorphisms of B, and B^G the set of all elements of B which are left fixed by every element of G. Show that B^G is a finitely generated A-algebra.

Exercise 7.6. If a finitely generated ring K is a field, it is a finite field. [If K has characteristic 0, we have $\mathbb{Z} \subseteq \mathbb{Q} \subseteq K$. Since K is finitely generated over $\mathbb{Z}$ it is finitely generated over $\mathbb{Q}$, hence by (7.9) is a finitely generated $\mathbb{Q}$-module. Now apply (7.8) to obtain a contradiction. Hence K is of characteristic $p > 0$, hence is finitely generated as a $\mathbb{Z}/(p)$-algebra. Use (7.9) to complete the proof.]

Exercise 7.7. Let X be an affine algebraic variety given by a family of equations $f_\alpha(t_1, ..., t_n) = 0$ $(\alpha \in I)$ (Chapter 1, Exercise 27). Show that there exists a finite subset I_0 of I such that X is given by the equations $f_\alpha(t_1, ..., t_n) = 0$ for $\alpha \in I_0$.

Exercise 7.8. If $A[x]$ is Noetherian, is A necessarily Noetherian?

Exercise 7.9. Let A be a ring such that (1) for each maximal ideal m of A, the local ring A_m is Noetherian; (2) for each $x \neq 0$ in A, the set of maximal ideals of A which contain x is finite.

Show that A is Noetherian.

[Let $a \neq 0$ be an ideal in A. Let $m_1, ..., m_r$ be the maximal ideals which contain a. Choose $x_0 \neq 0$ in a and let $m_1, ..., m_{r+s}$ be the maximal ideals which contain x_0. Since $m_{r+1}, ..., m_{r+s}$ do not contain a there exist $x_j \in a$ such that $x_j \notin m_{r+j}$ $(1 \leq j \leq s)$. Since each A_{m_i} $(1 \leq i \leq r)$ is Noetherian, the extension of a in A_{m_i} is finitely generated. Hence there exist $x_{s+1}, ..., x_t$ in a whose images in A_{m_i} generate aA_{m_i} for $i = 1, ..., r$. Let $a_0 = (x_0, ..., x_t)$. Show that a_0 and a have the same extension in A_m for every maximal ideal m, and deduce by (3.9) that $a_0 = a$.]

Exercise 7.10. Let M be a Noetherian A-module. Show that $M[x]$ (Chapter 2, Exercise 6) is a Noetherian $A[x]$-module.

Exercise 7.11. Let A be a ring such that each local ring A_p is Noetherian. Is A necessarily Noetherian?

Exercise 7.12. Let A be a ring and B a faithfully flat A-algebra (Chapter 3, Exercise 16). If B is Noetherian, show that A is Noetherian. [Use the ascending chain condition.]

Exercise 7.13. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism of finite type and let $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ be the mapping associated with f. Show that the fibers of f^* are Noetherian subspaces of B.

7.1 Nullstellensatz, strong form

Exercise 7.14. Let k be an algebraically closed field, let A denote the polynomial ring $k[t_1, ..., t_n]$ and let a be an ideal in A. Let V be the variety in k^n defined by the ideal a, so that V is the set of

all $x = (x_1, ..., x_n) \in k^n$ such that $f(x) = 0$ for all $f \in a$. Let $I(V)$ be the ideal of V, i.e. the ideal of all polynomials $g \in A$ such that $g(x) = 0$ for all $x \in V$. Then $I(V) = r(a)$.

[It is clear that $r(a) \subseteq I(V)$. Conversely, if $f \notin r(a)$, then there is a prime ideal p containing a such that $f \notin p$. Let $\overline{f}$ be the image of f in $B = A/p$, let $C = B_{\overline{f}} = B\left[1/\overline{f}\right]$, and let m be a maximal ideal of C. Since C is a finitely generated k-algebra we have $C/m \cong k$, by (7.9). The images x_i in C/m of the generators t_i of A thus define a point $x = (x_1, ..., x_n) \in k^n$, and the construction shows that $x \in V$ and $f(x) \neq 0$.]

Exercise 7.15. Let A be a Noetherian local ring, m its maximal ideal and k its residue field, and let M be a finitely generated A-module. Then the following are equivalent:

i) M is free;
ii) M is flat;
iii) the mapping of $m \otimes M$ into $A \otimes M$ is injective;
iv) $\mathrm{Tor}_1^A(k, M) = 0$.

[To show that iv) $\Rightarrow$ i), let $x_1, ..., x_n$ be elements of M whose images in M/mM form a k-basis of this vector space. By (2.8), the x_i generate M. Let F be a free A-module with basis $e_1, ..., e_n$ and define $\varphi : F \to M$ by $\varphi(e_i) = x_i$. Let $E = \ker(\varphi)$. Then the exact sequence $0 \to E \to F \to M \to 0$ gives us an exact sequence

$$0 \to k \otimes_A E \to k \otimes_A F \overset{1 \otimes \varphi}{\to} k \otimes_A M \to 0.$$

Since $k \otimes F$ and $k \otimes M$ are vector spaces of the same dimension over k, it follows that $1 \otimes \varphi$ is an isomorphism, hence $k \otimes E = 0$, hence $E = 0$ by Nakayama's Lemma (E is finitely generated because it is a submodule of F, and A is Noetherian).]

Exercise 7.16. Let A be a Noetherian ring, M a finitely generated A-module. Then the following are equivalent:

i) M is a flat A-module;
ii) M_p is a free A_p-module, for all prime ideals p;
iii) M_m is a free A_m-module, for all maximal ideals m.

In other words, flat = locally free. [Use Exercise 15.]

Exercise 7.17. Let A be a ring and M a Noetherian A-module. Show (by imitating the proofs of (7.11) and (7.12)) that every submodule N of M has a primary decomposition (Chapter 4, Exercises 20–23).

Exercise 7.18. Let A be a Noetherian ring, p a prime ideal of A, and M a finitely generated A -module. Show that the following are equivalent:

i) p belongs to 0 in M;
ii) there exists $x \in M$ such that $\mathrm{Ann}(x) = p$;
iii) there exists a submodule of M isomorphic to A/p.

Deduce that there exists a chain of submodules

$$0 = M_0 \subset M_1 \subset ... \subset M_r = M$$

such that each quotient M_i/M_{i-1} is of the form A/p_i, where p_i is a prime ideal of A.

Exercise 7.19. Let a be an ideal in a Noetherian ring A. Let

$$a = \cap_{i=1}^{r} b_i = \cap_{j=1}^{s} c_j$$

be two minimal decompositions of a as intersections of **irreducible** ideals. Prove that $r = s$ and that (possible after re-indexing the c_j) $r(b_i) = r(c_i)$ for all i. [Show that for each $i = 1, ..., r$ there exists j such that

$$a = b_1 \cap ... \cap b_{i-1} \cap c_j \cap b_{i+1} \cap ... \cap b_r.$$

]

State and prove an analogous result for modules.

Exercise 7.20. Let X be a topological space and let $\mathcal{F}$ be the smallest collection of subsets of X which contains all open subsets of X and is closed with respect to the formation of finite intersections and complements.

i) Show that a subset E of X belongs to $\mathcal{F}$ if and only if E is of the form $U \cap C$, where U is open and C is closed.

ii) Suppose that X is irreducible and let $E \in \mathcal{F}$. Show that E is dense in X (i.e., that $\overline{E} = X$) if and only if E contains a non-empty open set in X.

Exercise 7.21. Let X be a Noetherian topological space (Chapter 6, Exercise 5) and let $E \subseteq X$. Show that $E \in \mathcal{F}$ if and only if, for each irreducible closed set $X_0 \subseteq X$, either $\overline{E \cap X_0} \neq X_0$ or else $E \cap X_0$ contains a non-empty open subset of X_0. [Suppose $E \notin \mathcal{F}$. Then the collection of closed sets $X' \subseteq X$ such that $E \cap X' \notin \mathcal{F}$ is not empty and therefore has a minimal element X_0. Show that X_0 is irreducible and then that each of the alternatives above leads to the conclusion that $E \cap X_0 \in \mathcal{F}$.]

The sets belonging to $\mathcal{F}$ are called the **constructible** subsets of X.

Exercise 7.22. Let X be a Noetherian topological space and let E be a subset of X. Show that E is open in X if and only if, for each irreducible closed subset X_0 in X, either $E \cap X_0 = \emptyset$ or else $E \cap X_0$ contains a non-empty open subset of X_0. [The proof is similar to that of Exercise 21.]

Exercise 7.23. Let A be a Noetherian ring, $f : A \to B$ a ring homomorphism of finite type (so that B is Noetherian). Let $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, $Y = \mathrm{Spec}(B)$ and let $f^* : Y \to X$ be the mapping associated with f. Then the image under f^* of a constructible subset E of Y is a constructible subset of X.

[By Exercise 20 it is enough to take $E = U \cap C$ where U is open and C is closed in Y; then, replacing B by a homomorphic image, we reduce to the case where E is open in Y. Since Y is Noetherian, E is quasi-compact and therefore a finite union of open sets of the form $\mathrm{Spec}(B_g)$. Hence reduce to the case $E = Y$. To show that $f^*(Y)$ is constructible, use the criterion of Exercise

21. Let X_0 be an irreducible closed subset of X such that $f^*(Y) \cap X_0$ is dense in X_0. We have $f^*(Y) \cap X_0 = f^*(f^{*-1}(X_0))$, and $f^{*-1}(X_0) = \mathrm{Spec}((A/p) \otimes_A B)$, where $X_0 = \mathrm{Spec}(A/p)$. Hence reduce to the case where A is an integral domain and f is injective. If $Y_1, ..., Y_n$ are the irreducible components of Y, it is enough to show that some $f^*(Y_i)$ contains a non-empty open set in X. So finally we are brought down to the situation in which A, B are integral domains and f is injective (and still of finite type); now use Chapter 5, Exercise 21 to complete the proof.]

Exercise 7.24. With the notation and hypotheses of Exercise 23, f^* is an open mapping $\Leftrightarrow$ f has the going-down property (Chapter 5, Exercise 10). [Suppose f has the going-down property. As in Exercise 23, reduce to proving that $E = f^*(Y)$ is open in X. The going-down property asserts that if $p' \subseteq p$ and $p \in E$, then $p' \in E$: in other words, that if X_0 is an irreducible closed subset of X and X_0 meets E, then $E \cap X_0$ is dense in X_0. By Exercises 20 and 22, E is open in X.]

Exercise 7.25. Let A be Noetherian, $f : A \to B$ of finite type and **flat** (i.e., B is flat as an A-module). Then $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(B) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is an open mapping. [Exercise 24 and Chapter 5, Exercise 11.]

7.2 Grothendieck groups

Exercise 7.26. Let A be a Noetherian ring and let $F(A)$ denote the set of all isomorphism classes of finitely generated A-modules. Let C be the free abelian group generated by $F(A)$. With each short exact sequence $0 \to M' \to M \to M'' \to 0$ of finitely generated A-modules we associate the element $(M') - (M) + (M'')$ of C, where (M) is the isomorphism class of M, etc. Let D be the subgroup of C generated by these elements, for all short exact sequences. The quotient group C/D is called the **Grothendieck group** of A, and is denoted by $K(A)$. If M is a finitely generated A-module, let $\gamma(M)$, or $\gamma_A(M)$, denote the image of (M) in $K(A)$.

i) Show that $K(A)$ has the following universal property: for each additive function λ on the class of finitely generated A-modules, with values in an abelian group G, there exists a unique homomorphism $\lambda_0 : K(A) \to G$ such that $\lambda(M) = \lambda_0(\gamma(M))$ for all M.

ii) Show that $K(A)$ is generated by the elements $\gamma(A/p)$, where p is a prime ideal of A. [Use Exercise 18.]

iii) If A is a field, or more generally if A is a principal ideal domain, then $K(A) \cong \mathbb{Z}$.

iv) Let $f : A \to B$ be a **finite** ring homomorphism. Show that restriction of scalars gives rise to a homomorphism $f_! : K(B) \to K(A)$ such that $f_!(\gamma_B(N)) = \gamma_A(N)$ for a B-module N. If $g : B \to C$ is another finite ring homomorphism, show that $(g \circ f)_! = f_! \circ g_!$.

Exercise 7.27. Let A be a Noetherian ring and let $F_1(A)$ be the set of all isomorphism classes of finitely generated **flat** A-modules. Repeating the construction of Exercise 26 we obtain a group $K_1(A)$. Let $\gamma_1(M)$ denote the image of (M) in $K_1(A)$.

i) Show that tensor product of modules over A induces a commutative ring structure on $K_1(A)$, such that $\gamma_1(M)\cdot\gamma_1(N)=\gamma_1(M\otimes N)$. The identity element of this ring is $\gamma_1(A)$.
ii) Show that tensor product induces a $K_1(A)$-module structure on the group $K(A)$, such that $\gamma_1(M)\cdot\gamma(N)=\gamma(M\otimes N)$.
iii) If A is a (Noetherian) local ring, then $K_1(A)\cong\mathbb{Z}$.
iv) Let $f:A\to B$ be a ring homomorphism, B being Noetherian. Show that extension of scalars gives rise to a ring homomorphism $f^!:K_1(A)\to K_1(B)$ such that $f^!(\gamma_1(M))=\gamma_1(B\otimes_A M)$. [If M is flat and finitely generated over A, then $B\otimes_A M$ is flat and finitely generated over B.] If $g:B\to C$ is another ring homomorphism (with C Noetherian), then $(g\circ f)^!=f^!\circ g^!$.
v) If $f:A\to B$ is a finite ring homomorphism then

$$f_!\big(f^!(x)y\big)=xf_!(y)$$

for $x\in K_1(A)$, $y\in K(B)$. In other words, regarding $K(B)$ as a $K_1(A)$-module by restriction of scalars, the homomorphism $f^!$ is a $K_1(A)$-module homomorphism.

Remark. Since $F_1(A)$ is a subset of $F(A)$ we have a group homomorphism $\varepsilon:K_1(A)\to K(A)$, given by $\varepsilon(\gamma_1(M))=\gamma(M)$. If the ring A is finite-dimensional and **regular**, i.e., if all its local rings A_p are regular (Chapter 11) it can be shown that ε is an isomorphism.

8 Artin Rings

Exercise 8.1. Let $q_1\cap\ldots\cap q_n=0$ be a minimal primary decomposition of the zero ideal in a Noetherian ring, and let q_i be p_i-primary. Let $p_i^{(r)}$ be the rth **symbolic power** of p_i (Chapter 4, Exercise 13). Show that for each $i=1,\ldots,n$ there exists an integer r_i such that $p_i^{(r_i)}\subseteq q_i$.

Suppose q_i is an isolated primary component. Then A_{p_i} is an Artin local ring, hence if m_i is its maximal ideal we have $m_i^r=0$ for all sufficiently large r, hence $q_i=p_i^{(r)}$ for all large r.

If q_i is an embedded primary component, then A_{p_i} is **not** Artinian, hence the powers m_i^r are all distinct, and so the $p_i^{(r)}$ are all distinct. Hence in the given primary decomposition we can replace q_i by any of the infinite set of p_i-primary ideals $p_i^{(r)}$ where $r\geq r_i$, and so there are infinitely many minimal primary decompositions of 0 which differ only in the p_i-component.

Exercise 8.2. Let A be a Noetherian ring. Prove that the following are equivalent:
i) A is Artinian;
ii) Spec(A) is discrete and finite;
iii) Spec(A) is discrete.

Exercise 8.3. Let k be a field and A a finitely generated k-algebra. Prove that the following are equivalent:
i) A is Artinian;
ii) A is a finite k-algebra.

[To prove that i) $\Rightarrow$ ii), use (8.7) to reduce to the case where A is an Artin local ring. By the Nullstellensatz, the residue field of A is a finite extension of k. Now use the fact that A is of finite

length as an A-module. To prove ii) $\Rightarrow$ i), observe that the ideals of A are k-vector subspaces and therefore satisfy d.c.c.]

Exercise 8.4. Let $f : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism of finite type. Consider the following statements:

i) f is finite;
ii) the fibres of f^* are discrete subspaces of $\mathrm{Spec}(B)$;
iii) for each prime ideal p of A, the ring $B \otimes_A k(p)$ is a finite $k(p)$-algebra ($k(p)$ is the residue field of A_p);
iv) the fibres of f^* are finite.

Prove that i) $\Rightarrow$ ii) $\Leftrightarrow$ iii) $\Rightarrow$ iv). [Use Exercises 2 and 3.]

If f is integral and the fibres of f^* are finite, is f necessarily finite?

Exercise 8.5. In Chapter 5, Exercise 16, show that X is a finite covering of L (i.e., the number of points of X lying over a given point of L is finite and bounded).

Exercise 8.6. Let A be a Noetherian ring and q a p-primary ideal in A. Consider chains of primary ideals from q to p. Show that all such chains are of finite bounded length, and that all maximal chains have the same length.

9 Discrete Valuation Rings and Dedekind Domains

Exercise 9.1. Let A be a Dedekind domain, S a multiplicatively closed subset of A. Show that $S^{-1}A$ is either a Dedekind domain or the field of fractions of A.

Suppose that $S \neq A - \{0\}$, and let H, H' be the ideal class groups of A and $S^{-1}A$ respectively. Show that extension of ideals induces a surjective homomorphism $H \to H'$.

Exercise 9.2. Let A be a Dedekind domain. If $f = a_0 + a_1x + ... + a_nx^n$ is a polynomial with coefficients in A, the **content** of f is the ideal $c(f) = (a_0, ..., a_n)$ in A. Prove **Gauss's lemma** that $c(fg) = c(f)c(g)$.

[Localize at each maximal ideal.]

Exercise 9.3. A valuation ring (other than a field) is Noetherian if and only if it is a discrete valuation ring.

Exercise 9.4. Let A be a local domain which is not a field and in which the maximal ideal m is principal and $\cap_{n=1}^{\infty} m^n = 0$. Prove that A is a discrete valuation ring.

Exercise 9.5. Let M be a finitely-generated module over a Dedekind domain. Prove that M is flat $\Leftrightarrow$ M is torsion-free.

[Use Chapter 3, Exercise 13 and Chapter 7, Exercise 16.]

Exercise 9.6. Let M be a finitely-generated torsion module ($T(M) = M$) over a Dedekind domain A. Prove that M is uniquely representable as a finite direct sum of modules $A/p_i^{t_i}$, where p_i are non-zero prime ideals of A. [For each $p \neq 0$, M_p is a torsion A_p-module; use the structure theorem for modules over a principal ideal domain.]

Exercise 9.7. Let A be a Dedekind domain and $a \neq 0$ an ideal in A. Show that every ideal in A/a is principal.

Deduce that every ideal in A can be generated by at most 2 elements.

Exercise 9.8. Let a, b, c be three ideals in a Dedekind domain. Prove that

$$a \cap (b + c) = (a \cap b) + (a \cap c)$$

$$a + (b \cap c) = (a + b) \cap (a + c)$$

[Localize.]

Exercise 9.9. (Chinese Remainder Theorem). Let $a_1, ..., a_n$ be ideals and let $x_1, ..., x_n$ be elements in a Dedekind domain A. Then the system of congruences $x \equiv x_i \pmod{a_i}$ $(1 \leq i \leq n)$ has a solution x in $A \Leftrightarrow x_i \equiv x_j \pmod{a_i + a_j}$ whenever $i \neq j$.

[This is equivalent to saying that the sequence of A-modules

$$A \xrightarrow{\varphi} \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} A/a_i \xrightarrow{\psi} \bigoplus_{i<j} A/(a_i + a_j)$$

is exact, where φ and ψ are defined as follows: $\varphi(x) = (x + a_1, ..., x + a_n)$; $\psi(x_1 + a_1, ..., x_n + a_n)$ has (i, j)-component $x_i - x_j + a_i + a_j$. To show that this sequence is exact it is enough to show that it is exact when localized at any $p \neq 0$: in other words we may assume that A is a discrete valuation ring, and then it is easy.]

10 Completions

Exercise 10.1. Let $\alpha_n : \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{Z}/p^n\mathbb{Z}$ be the injection of abelian groups given by $\alpha_n(1) = p^{n-1}$, and let $\alpha : A \to B$ be the direct sum of all the α_n (where A is a countable direct sum of copies of $\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$, and B is the direct sum of the $\mathbb{Z}/p^n\mathbb{Z}$). Show that the p-adic completion of A is just A but that the completion of A for the topology induced from the p-adic topology on B is the direct product of the $\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$. Deduce that p-adic completion is **not** a right-exact functor on the category of all $\mathbb{Z}$-modules.

Exercise 10.2. In Exercise 1, let $A_n = \alpha^{-1}(p^n B)$, and consider the exact sequence

$$0 \to A_n \to A \to A/A_n \to 0.$$

Show that $\lim^1_{\leftarrow}$ is not right exact, and compute $\lim^1_{\leftarrow} A_n$.

Exercise 10.3. Let A be a Noetherian ring, a an ideal and M a finitely-generated A-module. Using Krull's Theorem and Exercise 14 of Chapter 3, prove that

$$\cap_{n=1}^{\infty} a^n M = \cap_{m \supseteq a} \ker(M \to M_m),$$

where m runs over all maximal ideals containing a.

Deduce that

$$\widehat{M} = 0 \Leftrightarrow \mathrm{Supp}(M) \cap V(a) = \emptyset \quad (\text{in } \mathrm{Spec}(A)).$$

[The reader should think of $\widehat{M}$ as the "Taylor expansion" of M transversal to the subscheme $V(a)$: the above result then shows that M is determined in a neighborhood of $V(a)$ by its Taylor expansion.]

Exercise 10.4. Let A be a Noetherian ring, a an ideal in A, and $\hat{A}$ the a-adic completion. For any $x \in A$, let $\hat{x}$ be the image of x in $\hat{A}$. Show that

$$x \text{ not a zero-divisor in } A \Rightarrow \hat{x} \text{ not a zero-divisor in } \hat{A}.$$

Does this imply that

$$A \text{ is an integral domain} \Rightarrow \hat{A} \text{ is an integral domain?}$$

[Apply the exactness of completion to the sequence $0 \to A \xrightarrow{x} A$.]

Exercise 10.5. Let A be a Noetherian ring and let a, b be ideals in A. If M is any A-module, let M^a, M^b denote its a-adic and b-adic completions respectively. If M is finitely generated, prove that $(M^a)^b \cong M^{a+b}$.

[Take the a-adic completion of the exact sequence

$$0 \to b^n M \to M \to M/b^n M \to 0$$

and apply (10.13). Then use the isomorphism

$$\lim_{(\leftarrow)_m} \left(\lim_{(\leftarrow)_n} M/(a^n M + b^m M) \right) \cong \lim_{(\leftarrow)_n} M/(a^n M + b^n M)$$

and the inclusions $(a+b)^{2n} \subseteq a^n + b^n \subseteq (a+b)^n$.]

Exercise 10.6. Let A be a Noetherian ring and a an ideal in A. Prove that a is contained in the Jacobson radical of A if and only if every maximal ideal of A is closed for the a-topology. (A Noetherian topological ring in which the topology is defined by an ideal contained in the Jacobson radical is called a **Zariski ring**. Examples are local rings and (by (10.15)(iv)) a-adic completions.)

Exercise 10.7. Let A be a Noetherian ring, a an ideal of A, and $\hat{A}$ the a-adic completion. Prove that $\hat{A}$ is faithfully flat over A (Chapter 3, Exercise 16) if and only if A is a Zariski ring (for the a-topology).

[Since $\hat{A}$ is flat over A, it is enough to show that

$$M \to \widehat{M} \text{ injective for all finitely generated } M \Leftrightarrow A \text{ is Zariski;}$$

now use (10.19) and Exercise 6.]

Exercise 10.8. Let A be the local ring of the origin in $\mathbb{C}^n$ (i.e., the ring of all rational functions f/g with $f, g \in \mathbb{C}(z_1, ..., z_n)$ with $g(0) \neq 0$), let B be the ring of power series in $z_1, ..., z_n$ which converge in some neighborhood of the origin, and let C be the ring of formal power series in $z_1, ..., z_n$, so that $A \subseteq B \subseteq C$. Show that B is a local ring and that its completion for the maximal ideal topology is C. Assuming that B is Noetherian, prove that B is A-flat. [Use Chapter 3, Exercise 17, and Exercise 7 above.]

Exercise 10.9. Let A be a local ring, m its maximal ideal. Assume that A is m-adically complete. For any polynomial $f(x) \in A[x]$, let $\overline{f}(x) \in (A/m)[x]$ denote its reduction mod m.

Prove **Hensel's lemma**: if $f(x)$ is monic of degree n and if there exist coprime monic polynomials $\overline{g}(x), \overline{h}(x) \in (A/m)[x]$ of degrees $r, n-r$ with $\overline{f}(x) = \overline{g}(x)\overline{h}(x)$, then we can lift $\overline{g}(x), \overline{h}(x)$ back to monic polynomials $g(x), h(x) \in A[x]$ such that $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$.

[Assume inductively that we have constructed $g_k(x), h_k(x) \in A[x]$ such that $g_k(x)h_k(x) - f(x) \in m^k A[x]$. Then use the fact that since $\overline{g}(x)$ and $\overline{h}(x)$ are coprime we can find $\overline{a}_p(x), \overline{b}_p(x)$, of degrees $\leq n-r, r$ respectively, such that $x^p = \overline{a}_p(x)\overline{g}(x) + \overline{b}_p(x)\overline{h}(x)$, where p is any integer such that $1 \leq p \leq n$. Finally, use the completeness of A to show that the sequences $g_k(x), h_k(x)$ converge to the required $g(x), h(x)$.]

Exercise 10.10.

i) With the notation of Exercise 9, deduce from Hensel's lemma that if $\overline{f}(x)$ has a simple root $\alpha \in A/m$, then $f(x)$ has a simple root $a \in A$ such that $\alpha = a \bmod m$.

ii) Show that 2 is a square in the ring of 7-adic integers.

iii) Let $f(x, y) \in k[x, y]$, where k is a field, and assume that $f(0, y)$ has $y = a_0$ as a simple root. Prove that there exists a formal power series $y(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$ such that $f(x, y(x)) = 0$.

(This gives the "analytic branch" of the curve $f = 0$ through the point $(0, a_0)$.)

Exercise 10.11. Show that the converse of (10.26) is false, even if we assume that A is local and that $\hat{A}$ is a finitely-generated A-module.

[Take A to be the ring of germs of C^∞ functions of x at $x = 0$, and use Borel's Theorem that every power series occurs as the Taylor expansion of some C^∞ function.]

Exercise 10.12. If A is Noetherian, then $A[[x_1, ..., x_n]]$ is a faithfully flat A-algebra. [Express $A \to A[[x_1, ..., x_n]]$ as a composition of flat extensions, and use Exercise 5(v) of Chapter 1.]

11 Dimension Theory

Exercise 11.1. Let $f \in k[x_1, ..., x_n]$ be an irreducible polynomial over an algebraically closed field k. A point P on the variety $f(x) = 0$ is **non-singular** $\Leftrightarrow$ not all the partial derivatives $\partial f/\partial x_i$

vanish at P. Let $A = k[x_1, ..., x_n]/(f)$, and let m be the maximal ideal of A corresponding to the point P. Prove that P is non-singular $\Leftrightarrow A_m$ is a regular local ring.

[By (11.18) we have $\dim A_m = n - 1$. Now

$$m/m^2 \cong (x_1, ..., x_n)/(x_1, ..., x_n)^2 + (f)$$

and has dimension $n - 1$ if and only if $f \notin (x_1, ..., x_n)^2$.]

Exercise 11.2. In (11.21) assume that A is complete. Prove that the homomorphism $k[[t_1, ..., t_d]] \to A$ given by $t_i \mapsto x_i$ $(1 \leq i \leq d)$ is injective and that A is a finitely-generated module over $k[[t_1, ..., t_d]]$. [Use (10.24).]

Exercise 11.3. Extend (11.25) to non-algebraically-closed fields. [If $\overline{k}$ is the algebraic closure of k, then $k[x_1, ..., x_n]$ is integral over $\overline{k}[x_1, ..., x_n]$.]

Exercise 11.4. An example of a Noetherian domain of infinite dimension (Nagata). Let k be a field and let $A = k[x_1, x_2, ..., x_n, ...]$ be a polynomial ring over k in a countably infinite set of indeterminates. Let $m_1, m_2, ...$ be an increasing sequence of positive integers such that $m_{i+1} - m_i > m_i - m_{i-1}$ for all $i > 1$. Let $p_i = \left(x_{m_i+1}, ..., x_{m_{i+1}}\right)$ and let S be the complement in A of the union of the ideals p_i.

Each p_i is a prime ideal and therefore the set S is multiplicatively closed.

The ring $S^{-1}A$ is Noetherian by Chapter 7, Exercise 9. Each $S^{-1}p_i$ has height equal to $m_{i+1} - m_i$, hence $\dim S^{-1}A = \infty$.

Exercise 11.5. Reformulate (11.1) in terms of the Grothendieck group $K(A_0)$ (Chapter 7, Exercise 26).

Exercise 11.6. Let A be a ring (not necessarily Noetherian). Prove that

$$1 + \dim A \leq \dim A[x] \leq 1 + 2\dim A.$$

[Let $f : A \to A[x]$ be the embedding and consider the fiber of $f^* : \mathrm{Spec}(A[x]) \to \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ over a prime ideal p of A. This fiber can be identified with the spectrum of $k \otimes_A A[x] \cong k[x]$, where k is the residue field at p (Chapter 3, Exercise 21), and $\dim k[x] = 1$. Now use Exercise 7(ii) of Chapter 4.]

Exercise 11.7. Let A be a Noetherian ring. Then

$$\dim A[x] = 1 + \dim A,$$

and hence, by induction on n,

$$\dim A[x_1, ..., x_n] = n + \dim A.$$

[Let p be a prime ideal of height m in A. Then there exist $a_1, ..., a_m \in p$ such that p is a minimal prime ideal belonging to the ideal $a = (a_1, ..., a_m)$. By Exercise 7 of Chapter 4, $p[x]$ is a minimal

prime ideal of $a[x]$ and therefore height $p[x] \leq m$. On the other hand, a chain of prime ideals $p_0 \subset p_1 \subset ... \subset p_m = p$ gives rise to a chain $p_0[x] \subset ... \subset p_m[x] = p[x]$, hence height $p[x] \geq m$. Hence height $p[x]$ = height p. Now use the argument of Exercise 6.]